



DAK GURU

A Self-Learning Portal for the LDCE Aspirants

www.dakguru.com

Postal Manual Volume VI

Consolidated Parts I, II & III — Verified Edition (v2)

Aligned with —

The Post Office Act, 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024)

The Post Office Rules, 2024 [G.S.R. 767(E) dt 16.12.2024]

The Post Office Regulations, 2024 [S.O. 5440(E) dt 16.12.2024]

and all subsequent amendments up to early 2026

⚠ IMPORTANT — Disclaimer

This booklet has been prepared strictly for examination purposes (LDCE IP, PS Group B and allied departmental tests).

Every rule, fee, limit, date and citation has been verified line-by-line against (a) the Post Office Act, 2023, (b) the Post Office Rules, 2024 [G.S.R. 767(E) dated 16.12.2024], (c) the Post Office Regulations, 2024 [S.O. 5440(E) dated 16.12.2024] including all subsequent amendments, (d) DO No. 01-01/2024-PO of Member (Operations), Postal Services Board dated 20.12.2024 with Annexure on Major Changes, and (e) the underlying Postal Manual Volume VI base text.

Statutory-update blocks within the text mark every place where the Manual text has been overridden or supplemented by current law. Readers are nonetheless advised to consult the original Gazette notifications, SB Orders, RBOs and DoP circulars for the most authoritative position before final reliance.

Table of Contents

This consolidated edition is organised in three parts, following the structure of the original Manual.

Part I — General Postal Operations

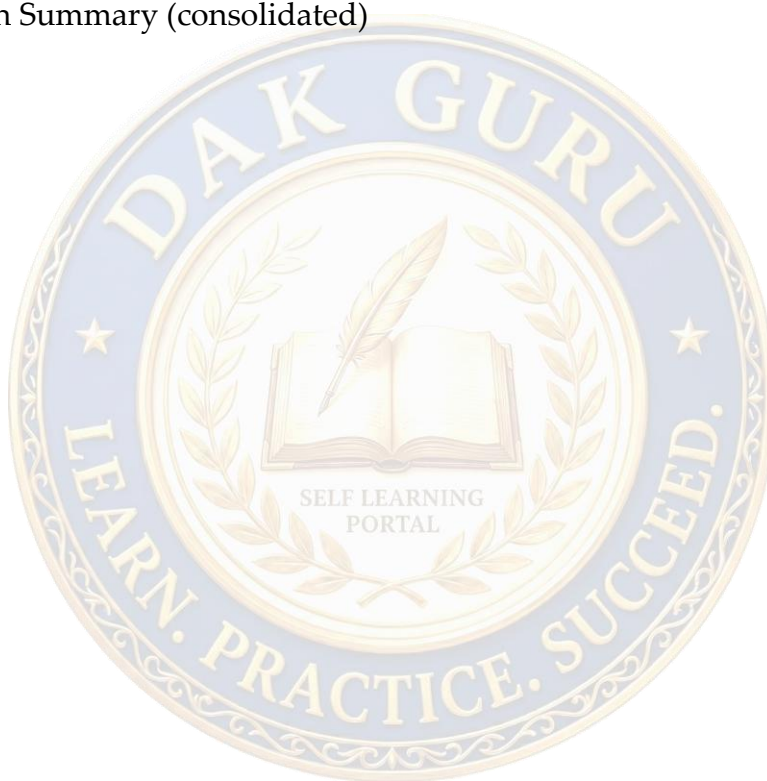
- Chapter 1 — Miscellaneous Rules
- Chapter 2 — Mail Department
- Chapter 3 — Sorting Department
- Chapter 4 — Delivery of Mails
- Chapter 5 — Deposit Department
- Chapter 6 — Registration / Accountable Items (incl. Speed Post)
- Chapter 7 — Parcel Department (India Post Parcel)
- Chapter 8 — Insured Articles
- Chapter 9 — Money Order Department
- Chapter 10 — Cash on Delivery (formerly V.P. Articles)
- Chapter 11 — Official Postal Articles
- Chapter 12 — Identification Cards
- Chapter 13 — Franking Machines
- Chapter 14 — Post Office Savings Bank (Administrative Rules)

Part II — Money Orders, Postal Orders & Allied Remittance Services

- Chapter I — Issue of Money Orders
- Chapter II — Despatch of Money Orders
- Chapter III — Payment of Money Orders
- Chapter IV — Refusal of Payment
- Chapter V — Alteration of Address or Payee's Name
- Chapter VI — Redirection
- Chapter VII — Stoppage of Payment
- Chapter VIII — Indian Postal Orders & e-IPO
- Chapter IX — Void Orders, Forfeiture & Preservation of Records

Part III — Duties of Postmen, GDS & Letter-Box Attendants

- Chapter 1 — Duties of Postmen (General)
- Chapter 2 — Delivery of Special Articles
- Chapter 3 — Payment of Money Orders by Postmen
- Chapter 4 — Cash Conveyance & Sub-Accounts
- Chapter 5 — Duties of Head Postmen
- Chapter 6 — Duties of Letter-Box Attendants
- Chapter 7 — Uniforms and Badges
- Chapter 8 — Prohibitions, Offences & Village Postmen / GDS
- Quick-Revision Summary (consolidated)



PART I

General Postal Operations

Chapters 1 to 14

Chapter 1 — Miscellaneous Rules

Rule 1. No gratuities to be taken by officials

- The Postmaster must see that, where it can be done without interfering with office work, officials assist illiterate persons in filling up Money-Order and other postal forms; he must strictly enforce the rule prohibiting acceptance of any fee or gratuity for such assistance.
- If professional letter-writers are allowed to work on the premises, the Postmaster must see that their charges conform to the prescribed scale and report any attempt at extortion to the Superintendent. Approved candidates and relatives of clerks must not be allowed to work as professional letter-writers.

Rule 2. Work on Sundays and Post Office holidays

- Savings Bank transactions, payment of Money Orders and delivery of ordinary mail are not, by default, carried out on Sundays and Post Office holidays; other work may be performed.
- As an exception, offices required to function on Sundays prepare the daily HO / SO accounts for Sunday transactions in the usual manner.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Business hours (Post Office Regulations, 2024)

Regulation 5 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (notification S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024) empowers the Circle Head, Regional Head and Divisional Head to fix the business hours of every post office in their jurisdiction, including working on Sundays and holidays, and to specify the services to be offered during such hours.

Rule 2-A. Night Post Offices

- Working hours of post offices are fixed by the Head of the Circle. The Director-General may extend the working hours of a post office up to 8:30 P.M. and keep it open on Sundays; such offices are termed Night Post Offices.

Work normally undertaken in extended hours at Night Post Offices:

Service	Transaction limit / details
Accountable items	Speed Post Document / Parcel and India Post Parcel may be booked; registration value-added service available.
Money Orders	Money Orders (formerly eMO) may be issued.
Stamps / IPO	Postal Orders (Rs. 10 / 20 / 50 / 100), National Savings Certificates and postal stamps may be sold.
Savings Bank	Related work up to 7:30 P.M.
Wire money payments	Up to 6:00 P.M.

Rule 3. Departments of a Post Office

The work of a large post office is divided into the following departments:

- Mails
- Sorting
- Delivery
- Deposits
- Accountable items (now: Speed Post Document & Parcel, India Post Parcel — see Chapter 6 of this Part)
- Parcels
- Money Orders
- Cash
- Sub-Account

Rule 4. Memorandum of Distribution of Work

- The Postmaster maintains a Memorandum of Distribution of Work in **Form MS-11**, showing the duties assigned to each official, prepared by the Postmaster where there is one or more PA, submitted to the Superintendent for approval.
- A nominal roll in **Form MS-12** is also maintained for Postmen and Village Postmen in offices where their strength is more than 25.
- In no case may the PA who discharges the duties connected with money order, saving bank or sub-account department be the **Treasurer** of the office.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Definition of "Post"

Regulation 3 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 defines *Post* as any system for collection, clearance, sorting, dispatch, conveyance and delivery of items by the postal network. "Item"

(Section 2(b) of the Act) means an indivisible article which the Post Office accepts for providing a service.

Rule 4-A. Attendance Register

- An Attendance Register in **Form S-37** is maintained in every post office having more than one clerk.

Rule 5. Village Sorting List

- A Village Sorting List in **Form M-52** is prepared by the Sub-Divisional Inspector / ASP and supplied to each branch office.
- A Route List in **Form M-53** is issued by the Sub-Divisional Inspector to the Village Postman.

Rule 6. Yearly Village Return

- During the **first 14 days of March** (1st to 14th, both inclusive) in each year, a return is kept by the **Sub-Account PA**, showing the number of articles of every class received for delivery in each village within the office's jurisdiction.
- On completion, the return is signed by the Postmaster and sent to the **Sub-Divisional Head**.

Rule 9. Receipts to be taken from addressees

- Receipts are taken from the addressees of redirected articles in cases where the article has been opened or damaged.

Rule 11. Assessment of Customs Duty

- Assessment of customs duty on inward foreign articles is the duty of the Customs Authorities; realization of the duty is the duty of the Post Office.
- Memo of Customs amount collection at the time of delivery — **MS-9(a)**.
- Schedule of customs duty and other charges realized in cash on articles received by the foreign letter mail — **ACG-90**.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the duty assessed is recovered before the article is delivered.

Rule 17. Payments in cash and notes; admittance of strangers

- Payments may be made in cash or by currency notes. The public have no right to demand change for notes.
- Strangers must not be admitted to the post office work-area; the Postmaster must enforce this strictly.

- Information received officially must not be made public; this restriction does not apply to disclosure to a competent Court of Law, the District Magistrate, or the Commissioner of Police / District Superintendent of Police.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Interception powers (Section 9, Post Office Act 2023)

Section 9 of the Post Office Act, 2023 now governs interception of postal items. The Central Government may, on the occurrence of any public emergency or in the interest of public safety or tranquility, or on grounds of the security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, or for preventing incitement to the commission of any offence, empower an officer to intercept, open or detain any item.

Rule 21. Custody of blank forms

- The Postmaster is responsible for the safe custody of blank forms, especially Money-Order forms and other accountable forms.
- The MO Oblong Stamp and Insurance Stamp are kept in the personal custody of the Postmaster.

Rule 23. Custody of Government Money

- One iron safe is supplied to every office for custody of cash and valuables.
- Larger head offices are supplied with two iron safes, with the order of the Head of Circle.
- Every safe supplied to an office will have **double locks**: the key of one lock will be kept during and after office hours with the **Postmaster**, and the other key by the **Treasurer**.
- Where the iron chest has **2 hasps**: one of the two locks should be a **padlock**; the other will be a **sparling lock**.
- Where the iron chest has **1 hasp**: a **sparling lock** shall be used.

Rule 24. Head of Circle Circular

- Circulars are ordinarily issued by the Head of Circle **once a month**.
- All circulars issued by the Head of Circles will be destroyed after **3 years**, counting from the month of April following the close of the official year in which they were issued.

Rule 25. Disposal of Records

Records must be preserved for the periods prescribed. Selected preservation periods:

Record	Preservation period
Registered list, Parcel list and mail lists received and despatched	2 years
Special error book maintained in saving bank dept.	3 years

Record	Preservation period
Postmaster's Order Book	3 years
List of silent Accounts received from SBCO	Permanent
Stock Book of a Post Office	10 years after the year in which it is replaced by a fresh stock book
Guard book containing depositors' application for duplicate passbook	10 years
Nominal Roll	Permanent

The following records may not be destroyed without the special permission of the Head of the Circle:

- Post office Order book **MS-8** (except in Branch office);
- Register of undelivered Passbooks in deposit in the Head Office;
- Post office certificate ledger.

Confidential records and books of Postmarks should be destroyed by ****shredding**** method.

Rule 25(A). Confidential Records and Character Sheet of an official

- After **2 years** from death.
- After **5 years** from retirement.
- After **25 years**, or **3 years after death**, whichever is earlier, in invalid pension cases.
- After **6 years** for officials who have been dismissed, removed or compulsorily retired from service as a disciplinary measure.

Rule 27. Remittances by post — Cash bag

- Ordinarily, cash in excess of **Rs. 250** should be enclosed in a cash bag.
- Cash bags must always be packed, closed and sealed by the **treasurer personally**, in the presence of the **sub-account clerk**, and weighed by the latter without any help from any other official.
- In sub offices which are not supplied with a cash seal, the **date seal** should be used in its place.
- If the remittance is made over loose to the carrier, he should be required to grant a receipt for the same in the treasurer's cash book.

- If money is remitted through a special carrier, the treasurer must see on the carrier's return to the office that an acknowledgement for the remittance has been granted by the receiving officer in his **book of diary**.

Rule 29. Submission by Head Offices of returns and documents to Audit office

- Schedule of UCR — **1st and 11th** of the month.
- Money Order returned — **2nd and 16th**.
- Money Order issued and paid — **2nd**.
- Void Money Order — **16th**.

Rule 32. Prepayment of postage in cash in inland unregistered packet

- **Big City** — minimum 500 packets.
- **Small Town** — minimum 250 packets.

Rule 32-1. Identification Cards — loss

- The loss of an Identification Card must immediately be notified by the Head of the Circle through his Circular.

Rule 32-2. Business Reply Cards

- The annual fee for Business Reply Cards is realised in advance and credited to **Unclassified Receipts (UCR)**.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Business Reply Envelopes / Cards — omitted under PO Regulations, 2024

The DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure) confirms that Business Reply Envelopes & Cards have been **omitted** as a product under the new Act / Rules / Regulations. The fee-collection mechanism described above continues to apply only to legacy registrations until they lapse.

Rule 42. Statistical Memorandum

- On the 1st of each month, a statistical memorandum is prepared by the Money Order, Registration and Parcel PA in prescribed form **MS-14(a)**.
- Statistical Abstract — **MS-14**.

Rule 54. Submission of memorandum of distribution of Pay and Allowances

- HO to Superintendent's office — on the **5th of the month following**.

Chapter 2 — Mail Department

Rule 57. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- Hours of clearance must be so fixed that mails reach the post office in time for their intended despatch.
- Letter boxes fixed in walls or pillars must be provided with movable plates showing the hours of clearance.
- The official clearing a letter box verifies that the lock is in good order, reports any defect immediately to the Postmaster, unlocks the box, empties the contents into his bag and locks the box again.
- Letter-Box Peons must carry a badge and a time-piece; while on their clearance rounds they are not allowed to distribute letters or perform other duties.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Mail products — rationalised under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure), Letter Post products have been rationalised as follows:

Letter — weight ceiling fixed at **500 grams**.

Letter Cards — no major change.

Post Cards — Printed-Communication Postcards, Competition Postcards and Meghdoot Post Cards are all merged into Post Cards. A new value-added feature: Post Card may be tendered for the **registration facility** on payment of the prescribed fee.

Book Post (new product) — subsumes Book Packets, Book Packets containing Printed Books, and Pattern and Sample Packets.

Periodical Post — Book Packets containing periodicals has been renamed Periodical Post; features and conditions retained.

Registered Newspaper — periodicity reset to "at least once in a week" per the Press & Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023. Newspapers with periodicity longer than a week migrate to Periodical Post.

Blind Literature — no major change.

Business Reply Envelopes & Cards — omitted.

Rule 60. Facing

- Articles cleared from letter boxes are brought to the facing table.
- Facing means arranging articles with the address side upwards and all addresses turned in the same direction.
- While facing, articles are divided into two classes: Letter Mail (letters, letter cards, post cards) and Packet Mail (Book Post, Periodical Post, Registered Newspapers).

Rule 61. Stamping

- All postage stamps on articles must be defaced with the date-stamp. The purpose of defacement is to prevent re-use.
- If a stamp has escaped defacement at the office of posting, it must be defaced at the office of delivery or at any intermediate office where the irregularity is noticed.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Postage deemed not prepaid

Regulation 7 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 provides that postage shall not be deemed to be prepaid if the stamp has been obliterated, defaced, torn, cut or otherwise rendered imperfect.

Chapter 3 — Sorting Department

Rule 64. Station Bundles

- When the number of articles of the Letter Mail (excluding accountable articles) for any post office or mail office exceeds 14, they are formed into a separate Station Bundle.
- The bundle is tied with a check-slip (Form M-7) facing outwards.
- When the number of articles for a State or Territory is sufficient to form a bundle but not enough for a station bundle to a single office, a Territorial Bundle may be prepared.
- Articles for which no station or territorial bundle can be formed are termed "Unsorted" and are disposed of in the Sorting Case.

Rule 65. Direct Mail Bags

- A Direct Mail Bag is a bag closed by a post office or mail office for another post office or mail office with which it is not in direct communication.
- A direct mail bag should be closed when the number of articles for a particular office exceeds 200, or when the articles are sufficiently bulky to fill a bag.
- The label must bear the letter "D" to distinguish the bag from an ordinary account or sorting bag.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Gyan Post (effective 01.05.2025)

Source: Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2025, notification **G.S.R. 263(E) dated 28 April 2025**, effective **1 May 2025**. Inserted as Regulation 92A in the Post Office Regulations, 2024.

Scope: Books / packets containing books (a) prescribed in syllabi by recognised boards, universities or autonomous bodies of Government, (b) of social, cultural or religious nature, or (c) text-books for competitive examinations.

Conditions: Must bear the inscription "Gyan Post" on the outside; no advertisements other than incidental announcements or book lists; each book must show printer/publisher name; commercial / business books not eligible; periodicals (magazines / journals at regular intervals) not eligible.

Minimum weight: 300 grams; **Maximum weight:** 5 kg; **Transmission:** surface mode only; **Tracking:** compulsory (trackable item); **Tariff:** Rs. 20 (min, up to 300 g) to Rs. 100 (max, up to 5 kg) + applicable GST. Registration, proof of delivery and insurance available as value-added services.

Rule 83. Sorting Cases

- The sorting case is divided into pigeon-holes, each labelled with the name of a post office, mail office or section. Labels are arranged geographically to facilitate sorting.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the sorting case used corresponds to the sorting list supplied by the Superintendent.
- The sorting case must be examined daily to ensure that no article is left in the pigeon-holes after the despatch of mails.

Rule 85. Missent Articles

- Missent articles are articles erroneously forwarded to an office other than the office of destination or the proper office of transit.
- Such articles must be stamped "Missent" and forwarded to their correct destination by the first available mail.
- A report of missent articles is made to the Superintendent. The Error Book is a separate record maintained for this purpose (do not confuse with MS-14, which is the Statistical Abstract).

Chapter 4 — Delivery of Mails

Rule 98. Limitation of Delivery

- Delivery of articles is limited to the hours fixed by the Head of the Circle.
- No person living within the limits of the post town is entitled to receive his letters at the window of the post office unless he rents a Post Box, or unless the article is one that cannot be delivered through postmen.

STATUTORY UPDATE — OTP-based delivery (Speed Post)

Source: Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025, notification S.O. 4375(E) dated 25 September 2025.

OTP-based delivery is offered as a **value-added service** for Speed Post Document and Speed Post Parcel; **fee: Rs. 5 + GST per item**. The item is handed over to the addressee only after successful confirmation of the OTP shared with the delivery staff.

Cross-reference: Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (S.O. 1329(E) dated 13 March 2026, effective 17 March 2026) introduced "24 Speed Post Parcel" between Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bengaluru and Hyderabad, in which OTP-based delivery is provided **free of charge** as a bundled service.

Rule 113. Window Delivery

- "Window Delivery" means delivery at the window of the post office to addressees or their authorised agents.

Articles delivered at the window include:

- articles addressed to "Poste Restante" or "To await arrival";
- articles bearing the superscription "To be kept till called for";
- articles for persons who have rented a Post Box;
- insured articles, COD articles and Money Orders exceeding the limit entrusted to a postman.
- The Postmaster must satisfy himself as to the identity of the person applying; if the person is not known, identification by a known person or satisfactory evidence of identity is required.

Rule 114. Delivery of Accountable Items

- Accountable items (Speed Post Document, Speed Post Parcel, India Post Parcel with registration value-added service, and Insured Articles) must be delivered to the addressee or his authorised agent.
- No such article may be delivered unless the addressee or his agent signs the receipt and the acknowledgement (where applicable).

STATUTORY UPDATE — Addressee-specific vs. address-specific delivery

Regulation 18, Post Office Regulations 2024:

Addressee-specific delivery: where the sender has opted for this value-added service (fee Rs. 5 + GST), the item is delivered exclusively to the addressee or to a person specifically authorised by the addressee.

Address-specific delivery: in other cases, delivery may be made to any adult member of the family at the address, provided the addressee has not lodged a specific objection.

Rule 115. Post Boxes

- The Post Box system enables regular recipients to obtain their letters at the earliest possible moment.

Conditions:

- a Post Box may be rented at any post office where the system is in force;
- the renter is supplied with a key;
- articles addressed to the Post Box number are placed in the box;
- the renter or his messenger may clear the box at any time during business hours.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Post Boxes under Regulations 46 & 47, PO Regulations 2024

Items not capable of being placed in the box: where an item cannot, in view of its size or nature (e.g. parcels, accountable articles), be placed in the box, an intimation slip is placed in the box [Regulation 46(c)(i)].

Withdrawal of facility: the Postmaster may withdraw the Post Box facility if the renter fails to clear the box for 7 days despite notice [Regulation 47].

Rule 120. Intimation of Arrival

- When an accountable, insured or COD article cannot be delivered by the postman (addressee absent, large amount etc.), an Intimation in **Form RP-53** is delivered to the addressee.
- The article is retained in the post office for 7 days (excluding the day of presentation).
- If the addressee fails to take delivery within this period, the article is returned to the sender.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital intimation and extended retention

Source: India Post Parcel administrative instructions under PO Regulations 2024.

Digital intimation: for trackable items (Speed Post / India Post Parcel) intimation may be sent by SMS to the mobile number on record.

Retention: undelivered parcels are retained for 7 days after the first delivery attempt.

Extension: the addressee may request retention for up to 7 additional days in writing (maximum total 14 days).

Rule 134. Refusal of Articles

- If the addressee refuses to accept an article, it is marked "Refused" and returned to the sender immediately.
- The postman's statement of refusal is to be accepted as correct unless there is evidence to the contrary.

- An addressee cannot accept the article while refusing to pay customs duty or other charges; he must either accept it with all charges or refuse it entirely.

Chapter 5 — Deposit Department

Rule 137. Articles addressed to deceased persons

- An article addressed to a deceased person is treated as unclaimed and disposed of accordingly, unless there is no doubt as to the title of the claimant to receive it.
- Where the title is clear (e.g. a near relative who has taken charge of the deceased's property), the Postmaster may deliver the article to that person on his granting a receipt and indemnifying the Post Office against future claims.
- In case of any dispute or doubt, the article is returned to the sender or to the Returned Letter Office (RLO) with the remark "Deceased".
- Insured or COD articles addressed to a deceased person must not be delivered without the specific orders of the Head of the Circle or other competent authority, unless the claimant produces a legal succession certificate.

Rule 138. Detention of articles in the Post Office

- Ordinary articles of the Letter Mail (unaccountable) which cannot be delivered are not detained for more than 7 days.
- Station articles (addressed within the post town) which are unclaimed are returned to the RLO after 7 days.

Exceptions:

- articles addressed to persons temporarily absent may be kept for up to 7 days, provided the Postmaster has reason to believe they will return;
- "Poste Restante" articles are kept for one month.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Standardised retention period

Regulation 43, Post Office Regulations 2024: retention period for all categories of undeliverable mail (accountable / Speed Post / India Post Parcel) where the addressee is not found is standardised to **7 days** from the date of the last delivery attempt. If the addressee refuses, return immediately (no detention).

Chapter 6 — Registration / Accountable Items (incl. Speed Post)

IMPORTANT — Status of Registration under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure), Registration as a service has **no major change** — it continues as a value-added feature. What has changed is the underlying mail product:

- (a) **Speed Post has been split** into **Speed Post Document** and **Speed Post Parcel** (two distinct products).
- (b) **India Post Parcel** is the new accountable Parcel product, subsuming Parcel (Ordinary) and Business Parcel.
- (c) **Postcards** can now also be tendered for registration facility on payment of prescribed fee — a fresh extension.

The rules in this chapter therefore apply mutatis mutandis to all accountable items: Speed Post Document, Speed Post Parcel, India Post Parcel (with registration VAS) and registered Postcards / Letters.

Rule 156. General Rules — Accountable items

Registration as a value-added service is compulsory for:

- any parcel exceeding 4 kilograms in weight;
- any insured article;
- any article containing a cheque, hundi, banknote or postage stamps;
- any article bearing the word "Registered" on the cover.
- The registration fee must be prepaid in addition to the postage.

Rule 163. Preparation of Registered Bundles

- When the number of accountable articles for despatch to any office or section exceeds 2, they are formed into a Registered Bundle.
- A Registered List (Form RP-32) is placed inside the bundle.
- The bundle is tied with a special knot (reef knot) and sealed with the registration seal.
- If the number of accountable articles is large or bulky, they are enclosed in a Blue Registered Bag (symbol "R").

Rule 170. Compensation for loss or damage

- The Director-General may grant compensation to the sender of an accountable article lost or damaged in transmission by post.

Conditions:

- the application for compensation must be made within 3 months of the date of posting;
- compensation is not payable if the loss is due to the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g. insecure packing).

Exclusions — no compensation is payable for:

- loss of currency notes (unless insured);
- damage to fragile articles not properly packed.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current compensation limits

Source: DoP compensation schedule (Schedule I, Table V of PO Regulations 2024).

Speed Post Document / Parcel — Double the Speed Post charges, or Rs. 1,000, whichever is less.

India Post Parcel (retail / contractual) — As per Schedule I, Table V (rate distinct for retail and contractual).

International accountable items (UPU) — 30 SDR (Special Drawing Rights).

Rule 174. Delivery to illiterate addressees

- If an accountable article is delivered to an illiterate addressee, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- The mark is attested by a respectable witness (other than the postman) personally known to the postman or the Postmaster.

Chapter 7 — Parcel Department (India Post Parcel)

STATUTORY UPDATE — Parcel rationalisation under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure), Ordinary Parcel and Business Parcel have been **subsumed in India Post Parcel** — a new accountable product.

India Post Parcel may be availed by **retail as well as contractual customers**, but the rate of postage for retail and contractual is **different**.

Features including weight and dimensions have been modified.

Rule 179. Examination of Parcels

- Parcels received for despatch are examined to ensure secure packing and compliance with the conditions of posting.
- If a parcel is not securely packed, or is packed contrary to the rules (e.g. containing prohibited liquids or sharp instruments), it must not be accepted for transmission.
- Every parcel must be weighed. If the weight exceeds the prescribed limit (20 kilograms for India Post Parcel), it must be returned to the sender.

 STATUTORY UPDATE — Dimensions and volumetric weight

Maximum length: 1.5 metres.

Maximum length + girth: 3 metres.

Volumetric weight: for light but bulky parcels, postage is charged on the volumetric weight, calculated as $L \times W \times H \div 5000$ (dimensions in cm, result in kg).

Rule 185. Transmission of Parcels

- Parcels are transmitted by surface mail unless the sender has paid the fee for air transmission.
- Parcels weighing more than 4 kilograms must be booked as accountable items (India Post Parcel).
- Parcels must be handled with care; they must not be thrown or dragged.

Rule 193. Redirected Parcels

- A parcel redirected to any place served by the Inland Post is chargeable with a redirection fee.
- The redirection fee is half the prepaid postage.
- No redirection fee is charged if the revised address is within the same delivery area or post town.
- If the addressee refuses to pay the redirection fee, the parcel is not delivered but treated as refused.

Chapter 8 — Insured Articles

Rule 196. Responsibility of the Post Office

- The Post Office is responsible for the loss of the postal article or any of its contents, or for any damage caused to it in transmission by post, provided that the article has been insured and the prescribed insurance fee has been paid.

Exceptions — the Post Office is not responsible:

- if the loss or damage is caused by the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g. defective packing);
- if the article contains prohibited goods;
- in cases of force majeure (e.g. earthquake, war);
- if the claim is not made within 3 months.

 STATUTORY UPDATE — Limitation of Government liability

Section 10, Post Office Act 2023: the Government incurs liability only where expressly provided for in the Act or in the regulations, and only in accordance with the prescribed conditions. There is no general right of action against the Government for loss, mis-delivery or delay of any item; insurance remains the principal route by which a sender may obtain compensation for loss.

Rule 200. Examination of Insured Articles (Conditions)

- Every article tendered for insurance is examined to ensure that it is securely packed and sealed.
- The seals must be distinct and must be impressions of the same private seal of the sender. The seal device must not be that of a current coin or merely a series of straight, curved or crossed lines.
- The envelope must be strong, non-transparent and must have no black or coloured border.
- The weight (in grams) and the insured value (in words and figures) must be noted on the face of the article.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Insurance limits (Financial Services Division)

Maximum insurance limit: up to Rs. 10,00,000 (Ten Lakh) for Speed Post articles at authorised Head Offices.

Branch Post Offices: limit for booking insured articles remains Rs. 600.

Currency notes by Insured Post: transmission of currency notes is limited to Rs. 20,000.

Rule 203. Delivery of Insured Articles

- An insured article may be delivered by the postman if the value insured does not exceed Rs. 500 (Manual figure used for examination purposes).
- If the value exceeds Rs. 500, or if the article is damaged or tampered with, it must be delivered at the window of the post office.
- In such cases an intimation in **Form RP-53** is sent to the addressee.
- The addressee must sign the receipt and acknowledgement. If the article is damaged, delivery is made in the presence of the Postmaster and a note of the contents and damage is recorded in the Error Book.

EXAM TIP — Manual figure vs operational practice

The departmental Manual continues to test the Rs. 500 doorstep-delivery limit. In operational practice, the postman's cash-handling / doorstep delivery limit is higher under current SB Orders (e.g. enhanced limits for AePS / IPPB transactions) — but for paper-based Vol VI Part I questions, use Rs. 500 unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Chapter 9 — Money Order Department

STATUTORY UPDATE — Money Order — Major Changes under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure):

- (a) **Electronic Money Order has been renamed simply "Money Order".**
- (b) **Family Allotment Money Order has been omitted.**
- (c) **Limit of Money Order raised from Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 10,000.**
- (d) **Retail Money Order — amount of remittance to a person in a month restricted to Rs. 25,000** (proviso to Regulation 147).
- (e) **Three types of MO now: retail MO, bulk MO, service MO** (Regulation 147).
- (f) **Free MO** for transmission to PM Relief Fund, PM CARES Fund, CM Relief Fund or any other such notified fund (Regulation 147(3)).

Rule 236. Issue of Money Orders

- Money Orders are issued on the prescribed form (M.O.-8). The remitter must fill in the entries in ink.

Prohibitions:

- no Money Order may contain any fractional part of a paisa;
- the amount of a single Money Order must not exceed **Rs. 10,000**;
- for retail MO, the amount remitted to a person in a calendar month must not exceed **Rs. 25,000**.
- The remitter may write a communication to the payee on the coupon portion of the Money-Order form; this portion is detached and given to the payee at the time of payment.

Rule 245. Alteration of Payee's Name or Address

The remitter of a Money Order which has not been paid may require:

- that the address of the payee be altered;
- that the name of the payee be altered;
- that the Money Order be stopped and the money repaid to him.

No additional fee is charged where:

- the alteration is only in the address of the payee (within India);
- the money is to be repaid to the remitter.
- If the name of the payee is to be changed to that of another person, a second commission (equal to the first) is payable.

- The remitter applies in writing to the Postmaster of the office of issue and encloses the Money-Order receipt.

Rule 268. Payment of Money Orders — Postman Limits

- Money Orders are paid by the postman at the address of the payee.

Maximum single-payment limit by a single Postman (Manual Vol VI Part II §26):

Category of Staff	Normal Rural —	Normal Urban —	Div Power — Head Rural	Div Power — Head Urban
Postman / MTS (doing delivery work)	Rs. 30,000	Rs. 40,000	Rs. 40,000*	Rs. 80,000*
Village Postman	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000
BPM / ABPM / GDS	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000

* Division-Head powers exercisable with prior consultation with Police. Head-of-Circle power — Unlimited with prior consultation with Police.

- The postman must satisfy himself as to the identity of the payee; if the payee is not known, identification by a respectable known person is required.
- The payee must sign the Money Order and acknowledgement in ink; thumb-impressions must be attested.

Rule 275. Unpaid Money Orders

- If the payee cannot be found or refuses payment, the Money Order is returned to the office of issue for repayment to the remitter.
- If payment is refused, the word "Refused" is written across the Money Order.

Rule 276. Currency, Void Status and Forfeiture

- **Currency period:** the period of currency of a Money Order expires with the close of the last day of the **second month following the month of issue**. Example: an MO bearing month-stamp October 2026 is current up to **31 December 2026**; from 1 January 2027 onwards it is treated as a Void MO.
- **Void status:** all MOs remaining unpaid at the expiry of the currency period are treated as void. A Void Money Order cannot be paid without the special sanction of the Head of the Circle or competent authority delegated by him.

- **PAO consultation rule:** no inland MO (original or duplicate) should be paid, and no claim for short-payment or excess-credit on account of an MO may be adjusted, after the expiry of **1 year** from the date of issue, without consulting the PAO (DAP).
- **MO complaint window:** complaints relating to MO may be preferred by the public within **12 months** from the date of issue of MO.
- **Forfeiture:** the amount or value of a Money Order unpaid beyond **three years from the date of booking** shall be forfeited; after expiry of that period, such amount or value shall be treated as revenue to the Government of India. Statutory source: Regulation 155 of the PO Regulations, 2024.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital tracking under APT 2.0

Money Orders are tracked digitally end-to-end. The statutory "void" status remains tied to the accounting cycle described above. In APT 2.0, unclaimed amounts are automatically classified as "Void MO" in the system after the prescribed period.

Rule 281. Loss of Money Order

- If a Money Order is lost in transit, a duplicate Money Order may be issued.
- The remitter or payee may apply for an inquiry. If the Money Order has not been paid, a duplicate is issued free of charge.
- The Post Office is responsible for the amount of the Money Order if it is proved that the Money Order was lost or paid to the wrong person due to the negligence of postal staff.

Chapter 10 — Cash on Delivery (formerly V.P. Articles)

STATUTORY UPDATE — VPP merged with COD under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure), **Value Payable Post (VPP) has been merged with Cash on Delivery (COD).**

COD has been extended to retail customers as well, not just bulk / contractual customers.

Old VPP rules from the Manual continue to apply mutatis mutandis to the corresponding COD operations until administrative instructions otherwise prescribe.

Rule 290. General Rules — COD

- Accountable parcels, accountable letters and accountable packets (Speed Post Document / Parcel, India Post Parcel) may be transmitted as COD articles.
- The sender declares the amount to be recovered from the addressee — the COD amount.
- **Maximum COD amount per article: Rs. 50,000.**

- Remittance to sender: directly into the sender's bank account via ECS / NEFT (the traditional VPP Money-Order route does not apply for new COD operations).

Rule 296. Detention of COD Articles

- If the addressee is not found or the article cannot be delivered, an intimation in **Form RP-53** is served.
- The article is retained for 7 days from the date of first presentation or the date of delivery of the intimation.
- On written request of the addressee, the article may be detained for a further period not exceeding 7 days (total 14 days).
- For the extra detention (days 8 to 14), a Warehousing Charge (Demurrage) is recovered from the addressee at the time of delivery.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Warehousing charges

COD Letters / Packets: Rs. 3.00 per day.

COD Parcels: Rs. 5.00 per day.

Exemption: no charge if the post office is closed, or if the delay is due to the fault of the service.

Rule 298. Procedure when COD is Refused

- If the addressee refuses the article or refuses to pay the amount due, the article is returned to the sender immediately — it is not detained.
- If the addressee fails to take delivery after the prescribed detention period (7 days, or 14 days where extension was granted), the article is treated as unclaimed and returned to the sender.

Chapter 11 — Official Postal Articles

Rule 305. Official Postal Articles

- Official postal articles must bear the superscription "On India Government Service" (O.I.G.S.) or "On Service" when posted by authorised government officials.
- They must bear Service Postage Stamps (overprinted "SERVICE"). Ordinary postage stamps should not be used on official correspondence unless service stamps are unavailable.
- The official's signature and designation must be entered in the lower left-hand corner of the article (or on the frank).

Rule 309. Unpaid Official Articles

- Official articles which are unpaid or insufficiently paid are not taxed with the usual double-deficiency penalty.
- They are charged with the single deficiency (actual amount due) only.
- The rule requiring prepayment of postage on parcels does not apply strictly to official parcels; however, postage should generally be prepaid.

Rule 312. Camp Articles

- Articles addressed to officers of Government "in Camp" are delivered without claim for any redirection fee, provided the officer is entitled to the privilege.
- This privilege is restricted to high-ranking officers listed in the "Camp List" issued by the Director-General.
- Special bags containing official mail for such officers are termed "Camp Bags".

Chapter 12 — Identification Cards

Rule 317. System of Identification Cards

- The Identification Card system enables strangers to establish their identity when applying for delivery of accountable / insured articles or for payment of Money Orders.
- Any respectable, literate person who can sign his name may apply to the Head Postmaster for an Identification Card.
- The application is accompanied by the prescribed fee and a passport-size photograph of the applicant.

Rule 319. Particulars of the Card

- The card contains a full description of the holder, his signature and his photograph.
- **Validity:** 3 years from the date of issue.
- On applying for a postal transaction, the holder produces the card; the postal official compares the signature and photograph on the card with the person and the signature on the receipt.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current fee structure

Fee: Rs. 100 (subject to periodic revision).

Validity: 3 years.

Note: With the implementation of Aadhaar-based biometric authentication for many postal services, the physical Identification Card system is less frequently used, but remains a valid statutory provision.

Chapter 13 — Franking Machines

Rule 322. Licensing of Franking Machines

- The Director-General may authorise the use of franking machines by government offices, commercial firms and private individuals for prepayment of postage.
- No machine may be used without a Licence issued by the Head of the Postal Division (Superintendent of Post Offices).
- The machine must be of a type and pattern approved by the Director-General.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Mandatory migration to RMFM

All older Electronic Franking Machines (EFMs) have been phased out. **Only Remotely Managed Franking Machines (RMFM)** are permitted for new licences and renewals. RMFM machines download funds remotely via a secure server (Credifon) and do not require physical travel to the post office for resetting.

Rule 324. Conditions of Use

- The franking-machine impression must be in bright-red ink and must show the value of postage, the name of the office of posting and the date.
- The user may print a slogan or advertisement alongside the frank impression, provided the design has been approved by the Licensing Authority.
- The user must maintain a "Daily Docket" or usage register showing the meter readings before and after use each day.

Rule 328. Posting of Franked Articles

- Franked articles must be tendered at the counter of the specific post office designated in the licence.
- Articles must be bundled according to the value of the frank (all Rs. 5 articles in one bundle, etc.).
- There is no limit to the number of articles that can be posted, but they must be presented within the business hours fixed for the purpose.
- Franked articles must not be posted in letter boxes; if found in a letter box, they are treated as unpaid.

Rule 329. Rebate on Franking-Machine Usage

- A rebate is granted on the total value of postage consumed during the previous month.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Rebate structure (RMFM users)

Up to Rs. 5,000 monthly consumption: Nil.

Rs. 5,001 and above: 3% rebate on the entire amount.

Articles must be sorted PIN-code wise (or as per Sorting District) and bundled correctly; the rebate is credited to the franking-machine account at the time of the next resetting / upload.

Rule 330. Resetting of the Machine

- For RMFM, physical movement of the machine is not required: the user deposits money in the designated bank / post office account and the credit is downloaded via the modem / internet connection.

Rule 334. Repairs and Withdrawal

- If a machine becomes defective, the user must immediately stop using it and report the matter to the post office.
- Repairs may be carried out only by the authorised agents of the manufacturing company. Breaking the Post Office seal by unauthorised persons is strictly prohibited.
- If the licence is cancelled or the user wishes to discontinue, the machine is surrendered to the post office for removal of the die / cancellation of the licence.

Chapter 14 — Post Office Savings Bank (Administrative Rules)

Rule 340. General Responsibility

- The Postmaster is responsible for the correct maintenance of Savings Bank accounts and for the safe custody of passbooks and other documents connected with them.
- Officers of the Postal Department are prohibited from disclosing the name of any depositor, or the amount deposited or withdrawn, except to the depositor himself or to officers of the Department concerned with the Savings Bank work.

Information may be disclosed to:

- a Court of Law;
- Income-Tax Authorities (under specific statutory provisions).

STATUTORY UPDATE — Secrecy and disclosure

Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018 (as amended) — Rule 13:

Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU-IND): data on high-value transactions is shared for AML/CFT compliance.

Income-Tax Department (SFT — Statement of Financial Transactions): cash deposits exceeding Rs. 10 lakh in a financial year are reported.

Rule 343. Application for Opening an Account

- Any person wishing to open an account fills in the application form (Form SB-3).
- The applicant must be introduced by a respectable person known to the Postmaster, or by a depositor having an account in the same post office.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the address and identity of the depositor are verified.

STATUTORY UPDATE — KYC (SB Order on KYC Master Circular)

Aadhaar Number and PAN are mandatory for opening any new account. If PAN is not submitted at the time of opening, it must be submitted within 6 months, failing which the account is frozen. A recent photograph is mandatory for all depositors.

Rule 345. Passbooks

- A passbook (Form SB-5) is supplied free of charge at the time of opening the account.
- The passbook must be presented at the time of every deposit or withdrawal.
- The passbook remains in the custody of the depositor; it is not retained at the post office except for the entry of interest or for examination by the Inspecting Officer.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Core Banking Solution (CBS)

System-generated passbooks: manual entries in passbooks are discontinued in CBS offices; all entries must be printed using the Passbook Printer.

Non-Home Branch: the depositor may present the passbook at any CBS Post Office in India for deposit / withdrawal (subject to the prescribed limits).

Rule 350. Deposits and Withdrawals

- Minimum first deposit (ordinary Savings Account): Rs. 500.
- Deposits may be made by cheque; credit is given only on the date of realisation of the cheque.
- The depositor presents the passbook and a withdrawal form (Form SB-7) signed by him.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current transaction limits (SB Orders)

Minimum balance — Rs. 500 (with cheque facility); Rs. 50 (without cheque facility).

Account maintenance fee (if minimum balance not maintained for one financial year) — Rs. 50 (deducted as account maintenance charge).

Interest rate (Q4 FY 2025-26) — 4.0% per annum.

Maximum balance — No upper limit for single / joint accounts.

Cash withdrawal at counter (without supervisory sanction) — up to Rs. 20,000.

ATM cash withdrawal — daily limit — Rs. 25,000 per day.

Withdrawal at GDS (Branch Office) — per customer — up to Rs. 20,000.

Rule 365. Silent / Inoperative Accounts

- An account in which no deposit or withdrawal has taken place for three complete financial years is treated as a Silent Account (now officially termed Inoperative Account).
- No transaction is permitted in an inoperative account until it is revived by the Postmaster after a fresh application and KYC documents are obtained from the depositor.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Terminology and interest

Terminology: "Silent Accounts" are now officially termed **Inoperative Accounts**.

Period: 3 financial years of inactivity.

Interest: interest continues to be credited to Inoperative Accounts (unlike the earlier rule, under which interest stopped).

Rule 370. Settlement of Deceased Claims

- On the death of a depositor, the amount standing to his credit may be paid to his nominee or legal heir.
- If a valid nomination exists (registered in the post-office records), the amount is paid to the nominee.
- Where there is no nomination, claims up to the prescribed limit may be settled by the competent authority (Postmaster / Superintendent) on the basis of a claim form and an indemnity bond.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Sanction limits for deceased claims (SB Order)

Sub-Postmaster — Up to Rs. 50,000 (no-nomination cases).

Head Postmaster — Up to Rs. 5,00,000.

Superintendent — Up to Rs. 10,00,000.

Regional / Circle Head — Above Rs. 10,00,000.

Note: For claims with a valid nomination, the Postmaster of the office where the account stands can settle the claim irrespective of the amount.

PART II

Money Orders, Postal Orders & Allied Remittance Services

Chapters I to IX

Introductory Legal Note (Part II)

IMPORTANT — Read first — current statutory framework

Part II operates today within the framework of the **Post Office Act, 2023** (in force from 18 June 2024), the **Post Office Rules, 2024** [G.S.R. 767(E) dt 16.12.2024] and the **Post Office Regulations, 2024** [S.O. 5440(E) dt 16.12.2024], as amended by the Post Office (Second through Seventh Amendment) Regulations, 2025 and the Post Office (First and Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

Where the original Manual text is overridden by current law, a STATUTORY UPDATE block follows the relevant rule.

Key Money-Order changes confirmed by the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure):

(i) eMO renamed simply "Money Order"; (ii) Family Allotment MO omitted; (iii) MO limit raised Rs. 5,000 → Rs. 10,000; (iv) Retail MO restricted to Rs. 25,000 per person per month; (v) Three product types: retail / bulk / service; (vi) Free MO for PM Relief Fund, PM CARES, CM Relief Fund and other notified funds.

- The Postmaster is personally responsible that the return submission to the PAO concerned are despatched on the due date.

Chapter I — Issue of Money Orders

Rule 1 – 7. Introductory Matters

These rules describe the constitution and general framework of the Money Order system. They are largely procedural and have been carried into the present MO regime under the Post Office Regulations, 2024 with the product redesignations noted in the introductory block.

Rule 2. Money Order Book (M.O.-8)

- Money Orders are issued on the prescribed form **M.O.-8**.
- The forms are available in books of **50 forms** each.
- Each Branch Office should keep only **2 books**.

Rule 6. Monthly Statistics — MO forms and stamps

Forms and stamps used in the monthly statistics workflow:

- **MO issued** — M.O.-2(s)
- **MO paid** — M.O.-4
- **Monthly Statistics Register** — M.S.-13
- **Monthly Statistics Abstract** — M.S.-14
- **Monthly Statistics Abstract — M.O.** — M.O.-14 (M.O. issued — M.O.-15; M.O. payment — M.O.-16)
- **Monthly Statistics Memorandum** — M.O.-14(a)
- **Monthly Summary for MO Issue** — M.O.-17 and M.O. Paid — M.O.-18
- The round and oblong MO stamps must always remain under lock and key in the personal custody of the Postmaster.
- In every case, the date of the round stamp will be the date on which payment is actually authorized by the postmaster.
- The date of the oblong MO stamp is the date on which the amount paid is actually entered in the accounts of the office.

Rule 8. Presentation of Money Order

- The remitter must fill in, in ink, on a Money-Order form (M.O.-8) the necessary entries, adding his signature at the foot.
- The remitter may write any communication he desires to the payee on the coupon.
- The Money-Order form, together with the amount of the order and the commission payable thereon, must be presented at the window of the post office during the hours prescribed for Money-Order business.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Money Order limits — current position

Source: PO Regulations, 2024 (Regulation 147 and proviso), confirmed by DO No. 01-01/2024-PO dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure).

Single Money Order maximum: Rs. 10,000.

Retail Money Order — additional cap: Rs. 25,000 per person per month (i.e., the total amount remitted through retail money order to a particular person in a calendar month shall not exceed Rs. 25,000).

Three types of MO under the new framework:

- (a) **Retail MO** — from one person to another within the country.
- (b) **Bulk MO** — from one person to many, or from many to one.

(c) **Service MO** — for departmental or official purposes.

Free MO — for transmission of contributions to the PM Relief Fund, PM CARES, CM Relief Fund or any other such notified fund [Regulation 147(3)].

Rule 9. Money Orders written in regional language

- When a Money-Order form is filled in a regional language not known at the office of issue, the Postmaster or the Money-Order Assistant must transcribe the particulars in English on the form before it is issued.
- If the remitter is unable to write, he must make his mark on the form in the presence of a witness who must sign the form and add his address.
- The witness should be known to the post-office staff; otherwise the remitter must be identified by a person known to the post office.

Rule 11. Realisation of Amount

- The amount of the Money Order and the commission must be paid in cash or by cheque (subject to the conditions in Rule 46).
- Postage stamps cannot be accepted in payment of the amount of a Money Order or the commission.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Postage stamps not valid for MO payment

Regulation 9(2), Post Office Regulations 2024: consistent with modern financial rules, postage stamps (used or otherwise) are strictly invalid for paying Money-Order commission or value. Only cash, cheque or authorised digital payment modes are accepted.

Rule 12. Receipt to be given to the remitter

- The Money-Order Assistant gives the remitter a receipt (Form M.O.-1) for the amount of the order and the commission.
- The remitter should ensure that the receipt bears the date-stamp of the office and the signature of the Assistant.
- The receipt should be preserved by the remitter until he receives confirmation that the Money Order has been paid.

Rule 13. Money Orders presented in large number

- Where a large number of Money Orders are presented for issue by a single remitter, he may be required to present them at the opening of the office or at such other time as the Postmaster may fix.

- A list showing the names and addresses of payees and the amounts of the orders must be presented in duplicate with the Money Orders.

Rule 14. Service Money Orders

- Service Money Orders are issued for departmental or official purposes.
- The words "On Service" must be written or stamped on the form.
- Service Money Orders are exempt from commission.

Data Schedule — Money Order Limits & Fees (current)

Service	Statutory limit	Notes
Single Money Order (retail / bulk / service)	Rs. 10,000	Raised from Rs. 5,000 by PO Regulations 2024 (DO 20.12.2024)
Retail MO — monthly per person	Rs. 25,000	Proviso to Regulation 147
Service MO	As per departmental rules	Commission-exempt; "On Service" superscription required
Free MO — PM Relief Fund / PM CARES / CM Relief Fund / other notified funds	Nil commission	Regulation 147(3)

Chapter II — Despatch of Money Orders

IMPORTANT — Operational context

Rules 19–33 describe the traditional manual process of checking and despatching Money-Order forms. In the APT 2.0 environment, despatch is instantaneous on booking: physical forms (M.O.-8) are retained at the booking office (except for specific audits) and the data is transmitted electronically. The principles of examination and responsibility, however, remain valid for departmental examinations.

Rule 19. Check of Money Orders

- The Money-Order Assistant examines the Money Orders to see that they are correctly filled in and that the amounts of commission have been correctly calculated.
- He then impresses the date-stamp of the office on the Money Orders and the receipts.

- The Assistant's signature on the receipt (M.O.-1) is a guarantee that the amount of the order and commission has been brought to account.

Rule 21. Examination of MO for issue

- **Register of MO received** — MO-3.
- As a general rule, when the number of MOs to be entered in a list is less than 4, the MO will be paid in the ordinary way, not under the pay-order system.
- MO payable by pay order or by cheque need not be entered in the register of MO received.
- The postmaster will have the round MO stamp impressed on each MO in the presence of the Money-Order PA, in the space provided for this purpose.
- In the MO — both in the acknowledgement portion and in the receipt — the reason for non-payment will be recorded by the Postman in case the payee is not available at the time of call.

Rule 23. Despatch of Money Orders

- Money Orders are sorted according to offices of payment or offices of exchange, and entered in the Money-Order Check List (M.O. 70) or the Registered List.
- They are despatched to the office of payment or sorting office in the manner prescribed for accountable articles.

STATUTORY UPDATE — MO transmission under APT 2.0

Under the MO (Electronic) system, despatch is electronic. Once the counter PA commits the transaction in the Point-of-Sale (POS) module, the MO is effectively despatched to the central server. The destination office (SO or HO) downloads the MO data for payment. Physical M.O. forms do not travel to the destination; they are preserved at the booking office.

Chapter III — Payment of Money Orders

IMPORTANT — Academic note

Procedural mechanics (witnessing, identification, attestation) remain largely consistent with the Manual text. Statutory limits (amounts, validity periods) have been updated by the Post Office Regulations, 2024 under the Post Office Act, 2023.

Rule 26. Limit of amount of Payment by a single Postman

Single-payment cash carrying limits prescribed under the Manual / Security-Branch instructions:

Category of Staff	Normal Rural	Normal Urban	Div Head — Rural	Div Head — Urban
Postman / MTS (delivery work)	Rs. 30,000	Rs. 40,000	Rs. 40,000*	Rs. 80,000*
Village Postman	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000
BPM / ABPM / GDS	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000

- *Division-Head enhanced powers exercisable only with prior consultation with Police.
- **Power of Head of Circle** — Unlimited, with prior consultation with Police.

Rule 27. MO for payment by Postman

- No receipt for the amounts will be taken in the treasurer's cash book (ACG-2) from the Postman.
- The total amount given to all the postmen at one time will be entered by the treasurer in his cash book, and the MO PA must place his initial against the lumpsum entry in that book before he takes back the register of MO received.

Rule 28. Payment of SBMO — Workflow

Operational workflow for SBMO (Savings-Bank Money Order) payment:

- **Step 1:** MO Paid Assistant
- **Step 2:** Postmaster (after round MO stamping)
- **Step 3:** MO Paid Assistant (after entry in MO-3 register)
- **Step 4:** APM Sub-Account (Savings Bank) — after signing and sealing both MO and Acknowledgement
- **Step 5:** Counter PA

Rule 34. Payment of Money Orders

- A Money Order must be paid to the payee named in it, or to a person authorised in writing by the payee.
- The signature of the payee or his authorised agent must be obtained on the Money Order and on the acknowledgement.
- Payment is made at the address of the payee.
- Maximum remittance limit: **Rs. 10,000** per Money Order (with retail MO subject to the Rs. 25,000 per-person-per-month cap).

Rule 35. Identification of payee

- If the payee is not known to the postman or paying officer, he must be identified by a person known to the postman or such officer.
- The identifier signs the Money Order in the space provided and adds his address.

Rule 36. Payment to illiterate payees

- If the payee is unable to write, he must produce a witness to attest his mark or thumb-impression on the Money Order and acknowledgement.
- The witness signs the Money Order and the acknowledgement and adds his address.
- The witness should be known to the postman or paying officer; otherwise the witness himself must be identified.
- The postman or other officer paying the Money Order cannot act as the witness.

Rule 37. Payment to purdah-nashin women

- Where a Money Order is payable to a purdah-nashin woman who has no authorised agent, the signature or mark of the payee must be attested by a witness known to the postman or paying officer.
- If the witness is not known, he must be identified.
- The witness must certify on the Money Order that the payment was made to the purdah-nashin woman in his presence.

Rule 38. Payment to minors

- A Money Order payable to a minor must be paid to the father or lawful guardian of the minor.
- If the minor has no father or lawful guardian living with him, the Money Order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the minor is for the time being, on signing an indemnity bond in the prescribed form.

Rule 39. Payment to lunatics

- A Money Order payable to a lunatic must be paid to the manager of his estate, if one has been appointed.
- If no manager has been appointed, the Money Order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the lunatic is for the time being, on his signing an indemnity bond.

Rule 41. MO Paid by Book Transfer

Receipt	Payment
Drawn from Treasuries	Money Order Paid

Rule 42. Money Order Paid to wrong Person

- Amount must be recovered from the wrong person and credited to **UCR** (Unclassified Receipts).
- Again, payment to the right person and debited to **UCP** (Unclassified Payments).
- The recovery should be shown in the schedule **Form ACG-6(a)** — schedule of unclassified payment.
- If the amount is recovered from the wrong person and payment of MO is not done within 3 months from the date of issue of MO, the previous authority of the PAO should be obtained before payment is made.

Rule 43. Disposal of Payee's Acknowledgement

- If the remitter asks for a copy of the acknowledgement of payment, the postmaster should furnish him free of charge, with a certificate of payment in the prescribed form.

Rule 44. Entries in Journal of MO Paid

- Only MO paid within currency should be included in the journal of MO paid — form **MO-4**.

Rule 45. Payment of MO by Pay Order

- The MOs to be paid to each payee should be entered in a **triplicate list** in form **MO-20**.
- A **separate list** is prepared for each circle of audit for MOs issued during the month.
- Pay Order will be adopted when the number of MOs is 4 or more.

Chapter IV — Refusal of Payment

Rule 41. Refusal of payment by payee

- If the payee refuses to take payment of a Money Order, the amount of the order is returned to the remitter.
- The commission paid on the issue of the Money Order is not refunded.
- The Money Order is returned to the office of issue superscribed with the word "Refused" and the signature of the postman or officer to whom payment was refused.

Chapter V — Alteration of Address or Payee's Name

Rule 42. Alteration of address or name of payee

- The remitter of a Money Order which has not been paid may require that the address of the payee be altered, or that the name of the payee be changed.

- The remitter must apply in writing to the post office at which the order was issued, and must produce the receipt given to him for the order.
- If the Money Order has not left the office of issue, the alteration is made at once without charge.
- If the Money Order has been despatched, the application is forwarded to the office of payment.
- **Alteration of Payee Name** — generally not permitted (no provision for alteration of payee's name to a different person without a second commission).
- **Alteration of address of Payee** — the address of the payee can be changed, or the MO can be redirected to another address, free of cost.

Chapter VI — Redirection

Rule 43. Redirection of Money Orders

- A Money Order may be redirected to the payee at a new address on his written request or on the written request of the remitter.
- **Inland Money Orders:** redirection of an inland Money Order is effected free of charge.
- The instructions regarding redirection of articles of the Letter Mail apply generally to the redirection of Money Orders.
- A Money Order redirected to a foreign country is subject to the rules governing Foreign Money Orders and may be liable to a deduction for fresh commission.

Chapter VII — Stoppage of Payment

Rule 44. Stoppage of payment

- The remitter of a Money Order may stop payment of the amount to the payee and require that the money be repaid to himself.
- The remitter applies in writing to the post office at which the Money Order was issued and produces the receipt.
- The Postmaster records the request and, if the order has been despatched, communicates with the office of payment by the quickest available means (including electronic transmission).
- The Post Office is not liable if payment is made to the payee before the stop-payment instructions reach the paying office.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Limitation of liability

Section 10, Post Office Act 2023: the Government incurs no liability for the payment of a Money Order to the payee if the stop-payment request was not received in time to prevent such payment. The onus of proving the timing of the request lies on the remitter.

Data Schedule — Service Requests & Fees

Service Request	Condition	Fee / charge
Refusal by Payee	Return to remitter	Commission forfeited
Alteration of Payee's address	Within India	Free
Alteration of Payee's name	To a different person	Second commission (equal to first)
Redirection (Inland)	Within India	Free
Stoppage of Payment	Before payment	Free (commission not refunded)

Chapter VIII — Indian Postal Orders & e-IPO**Rule 180. Supply and Sale**

- **Indian Postal Orders are available in denominations of Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50 and Rs. 100** (under the PO Regulations, 2024).
- They are sold at all Head and Sub-Post Offices and at such Branch Post Offices as may be authorised in this behalf.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — e-IPO availability

In addition to physical IPOs, **Electronic Indian Postal Orders (e-IPO)** are available for Indian citizens (in India and abroad) to pay fees under the Right to Information Act, 2005.

e-IPO denomination: Rs. 10 (single denomination under PO Regulations, 2024).

Rule 180-A. Commission

- The commission payable on the issue of Indian Postal Orders is at the rates prescribed by the Central Government from time to time (Table II of Schedule V to PO Regulations, 2024).

Rule 180-B. Broken Amounts (Stamp-affixing rule)

- If a remitter wishes to remit a sum which is not equal to one of the fixed denominations, he may make up the difference by affixing unused postage stamps to the face of the Postal Order.

Conditions for affixing stamps:

- the number of stamps affixed must **not exceed 4**;
- stamps must be affixed in the space provided on the face of the order, or on the reverse if the face space is inadequate.

Rule 180-C. Crossing of Postal Orders

- An Indian Postal Order may be crossed generally or specially, like a cheque.
- General crossing: if the order bears across its face two parallel transverse lines, payment is made only to a banker.
- Special crossing: if the name of a bank is added between the lines, payment is made only to that specific bank.

Rule 158/180-D. Period of Currency (Validity)

- Indian Postal Orders presented for payment within **24 months** from the last day of the month of issue are encashable without a second commission.
- If presented after 24 months but before 36 months, they are paid only on payment of a **second commission** at the rate in Table II of Schedule V, payable in postage stamps affixed to the back of the order or through cash receipt.
- Orders presented more than **36 months** after the last day of the month of issue are time-barred and forfeited.

EXAM TIP — Worked example

If an IPO is issued on 15 January 2026, the "last day of the month of issue" is **31 January 2026**.

First period (no fee): valid until 31 January 2028.

Second period (with fee): valid until 31 January 2029.

Forfeited: after 31 January 2029.

Rule 183. Payment to the Public

- The payee must sign the order in ink in the space provided for "Received the sum of ...".
- If the payee is illiterate, his mark or thumb-impression must be attested by a witness known to the Postmaster or identified to his satisfaction.
- The paying Postmaster must verify that the order is genuine, bears the date-stamp of the office of issue, and has not been altered or erased.

Rule 189. Repayment to Purchaser

- The purchaser of an Indian Postal Order may obtain repayment of its value (but not the commission) by presenting the order and the counterfoil at the office of issue.
- He must sign the receipt on the order, adding the word "Purchaser" after his signature.

Data Schedule — IPO Validity Timeline

Time from last day of month of issue	Status	Requirement for payment
0 – 24 months	Valid	None (paid at face value)
24 – 36 months	Lapsed	Second commission (stamps on back / cash receipt)
> 36 months	Time-barred	Forfeited (cannot be paid)

Chapter IX — Void Orders, Forfeiture & Preservation of Records**Rule 65. Period of currency of MOs**

- The period of currency of a Money Order expires with the **close of the last day of the second month following the month of issue.**
- Example: a money order bearing the month-stamp impression of October 2026 is current up to **31 December 2026**. After 31 December, it will be treated as Void MO.
- All MOs remaining unpaid at the expiry of this period will be treated as void.

Rule 66. Payment of MOs whose period of currency has expired

- When an MO bearing the remark in red ink "currency expired — held over for payment" is paid, the amount should be charged in "**Void MO Paid**" and not in MO Paid.
- The particulars of the order should not be entered in the Journal of MO(M.O.-4) Paid but should be shown by the HO in schedule of Void MO Paid.
- If the period of currency of an MO in deposit has been allowed to expire and it is to be redirected or returned to the office of issue, the remark "currency expired — held over for payment" applies.

Rule 67. Payment of MOs within 1 Year and after 1 Year — Three distinct timelines

- **MO complaint window — 12 months from date of issue.** Complaints relating to MO can be preferred by the public within 12 months from the date of issue of the MO.

- **PAO consultation rule — 1 year.** No inland MO (original or duplicate) should be paid, and no claim for short-payment or excess-credit on account of an MO may be adjusted, after expiry of 1 year from the date of issue, without consulting the PAO (DAP).
- **Forfeiture — 3 years from date of booking.** The amount or value of a Money Order unpaid beyond three years from the date of booking shall be forfeited; after expiry of the said period, such amount or value shall be treated as revenue to the Government of India.

Rule 68. Alteration of Payee Name

- There is no provision for alteration of Payee Name (to another person) without a second commission.

Rule 69. Alteration in address of Payee

- The address of the Payee can be changed, or the MO can be redirected to another address, **free of cost.**

Rule 76. Description of Void MO

- MOs treated as void by the HO and void orders from the SO will be sent to the PAO concerned with the list of void orders on the **16th of the next month.**
- The schedule of void MOs for the home postal accounts office should be prepared in **duplicate**, and that for each foreign postal account office in **triplicate** by means of carbon paper.

Rule 78. Void Orders re-issued by PAO

- If a re-issued void MO is unclaimed, it will be returned to the **PAO which re-issued it** and not to the post office by which the MO was originally issued.
- Such MOs **must not** be included in the list of Void MO.

Rule 81. Due dates for submission of MO list in HO

- **First Period** — 20th of the Month.
- **Second Period** — 6th of the next month.
- If there are no entries to be made in the list, a blank form should not be sent.

Rule 85. List of void orders

- **MO-19** will be prepared month-wise and sent to PAO on the **16th** of each month.
- Example — The MOs issued in April which are treated as void are listed and submitted to the Postal Account Office on the **16th of July.**
- If there are no void orders to be sent to the PAO on the 16th of a month, a blank list with the word "NIL" written on it and signed by the Head Postmaster should be submitted.

Rule 212. Preservation of Records

Journals, accounts and books relating to Money-Order business are preserved for the periods specified below, calculated generally from the completion of the record or the close of the year to which they relate.

Annexure I — Essential Registers & Journals

Record name	Form No.	Preservation period
Book of MO Receipts	MO-1	2 years
Journal of MOs Issued	MO-2	18 months
Register of MOs Received	MO-3	18 months
Journal of MOs Paid	MO-4	18 months
Compilation of MOs Paid	MO-20 / MO-23	18 months
Compilation of Daily Totals (Issued)	MO-22	18 months
Postman's Book	MS-27	18 months

Annexure II — Specialised Money-Order Records

Record name	Description	Preservation period
Bulk Money-Order Lists	Lists presented by remitters for bulk booking	6 months
TMO / e-MO Advice	Telegraphic / Electronic MO advice received	18 months
Foreign Money Orders	Records of Inward / Outward exchange offices	3 years
Audit Case Files	Files containing paid MOs received from Audit	2 years
Round Money-Order Stamp	Impression book (if separately maintained)	18 months

Annexure III — General Accounts (Applicable to MO Branch)

Record name	Form No.	Preservation period
Sub-Office Daily Account	ACG-22	18 months
Sub-Office Slip	PA-3	18 months
Branch Office Daily Account	ACG-22(B)	2 years
Branch Office Slip	PA-5	2 years
Treasury Remittance Book	ACG-8	10 years

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital context — APT 2.0

Physical retention: the periods above apply strictly to physical printouts, counterfoils and journals generated at the post office.

Digital archives: in the APT 2.0 environment, transaction data (MO booking / payment logs) is archived centrally on the server for periods often exceeding 10 years for audit trails, independent of physical-record destruction.

Destruction protocol: no record may be destroyed without the specific order of the Head of the Office (Postmaster / Superintendent), after verifying that no audit objection or inquiry is pending against the relevant period.



PART III

Duties of Postmen, GDS & Letter-Box Attendants

Chapters 1 to 8

Chapter 1 — Duties of Postmen (General)

Rule 1. Head Postmen

- Head Postmen are employed in all large offices to convey money to and from the treasury / bank, to distribute the work of the delivery department, to examine the postmen's books and to perform other special duties.
- They may also be employed to make inquiries into minor complaints and to verify the payment of Money Orders.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Underlying framework

The operational role of Head Postmen continues; the underlying statutory framework is now the **Post Office Act, 2023** (in force from 18 June 2024, replacing the Indian Post Office Act, 1898) read with the **Post Office Rules, 2024** [G.S.R. 767(E) dt 16.12.2024] and the **Post Office Regulations, 2024** [S.O. 5440(E) dt 16.12.2024].

Rule 2. Knowledge of Postal Business

- Postmen must know thoroughly the rates of inland postage, the commission on Money Orders, the charges for insurance and the fee for registration.
- They must be fully competent to fill up the forms with which the public ordinarily deal — especially Money-Order forms and forms relating to the Cash-on-Delivery (COD, formerly V.P.) system.
- They must be able to describe the principal features and advantages of the Savings Bank, Post Office Certificates, Money Order, accountable-item services (Speed Post / India Post Parcel) and other postal systems.

Rule 3. Supply of Forms to be Carried

Every postman must carry with him a stock of:

- Money-Order forms;
- Acknowledgement forms;
- Forms of application for the purchase of Postal Certificates;

- Savings Bank deposit forms.
- He should also carry a small stock of postage stamps and stationery for sale to the public.

Rule 4. Postman's Book (Form MS-27)

- Every postman is supplied with a book in **Form MS-27**, in which he enters the particulars of all accountable, insured and COD articles, and Money Orders entrusted to him for delivery or payment.
- The Postman's Book is examined and initialled by the Postmaster or Head Postman daily, before the postman proceeds on his beat and on his return.

Rule 5. Addresses to be Noted on Articles

- The postman must note the name of the addressee on articles made over to him for delivery wherever he cannot himself read the language in which the address is written.
- This rule applies especially to articles addressed in English delivered by postmen not conversant with that language.
- Assistance in reading addresses should be obtained from the Head Postman or other officers of the post office.

Rule 6. Damaged Articles to be Noticed

- A postman must not receive any article which appears to be damaged or tampered with, without bringing the fact to the notice of the Postmaster or the officer-in-charge of the delivery department.
- If he detects any injury to an article after it has been made over to him, he must immediately show it to the Postmaster.

Rule 7. Receipts for Articles Issued for Delivery

- The postman must give a receipt to the Registration / Parcel Assistant or the Treasurer for all accountable, insured and COD articles, and Money Orders made over to him for delivery.
- The receipt is given in the designated columns of the registers or lists from which the articles are issued.

Rule 8. Book of Receipts for Intimations and Notices Delivered (RP-53)

- Postmen are supplied with a book of receipts (**Form RP-53**) for intimations and notices delivered by them.
- When a postman delivers an intimation regarding a COD article or an Insured article exceeding Rs. 500 (Manual limit), he must obtain the signature of the addressee in this book.
- **RP-53 is also used for parcels weighing above 10 kg.**

✎ EXAM TIP — Doorstep delivery limits — Manual figure vs operational practice

The Manual figure of Rs. 500 continues to be the examination-default. In operational practice, doorstep cash-handling limits for postmen / GDS have been enhanced by SB Orders (e.g. for AePS-linked transactions and specific IPPB activities). For Vol. VI Part III examination purposes, use Rs. 500 unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Rule 9. Instructions for Delivery

- Each postman's beat is fixed by the Postmaster, and he must on no account deviate from the beat prescribed.
- He must deliver articles at the address given on them.
- If the addressee cannot be found at the given address, enquiry regarding his changed address should be made from the neighbours.
- Postmen, while on duty, are prohibited from distributing advertisements, handbills, trade circulars or notices of any description on behalf of members of the public.

Rule 10. Realisation of Postage Before Delivery

- A postman is forbidden to deliver any article on which postage, customs duty or any other sum is due, until the full amount has been realised.
- He is not bound to give change.
- If the addressee refuses to pay the amount due, the article is taken back to the post office and treated as refused.

Chapter 2 — Delivery of Special Articles**Rule 11. Receipts of Addressees for Accountable Articles**

- A postman must not deliver an accountable item (Speed Post Document / Parcel, India Post Parcel with registration VAS, registered Postcard / Letter) without obtaining the signature of the addressee (or his agent) on the receipt and acknowledgement (if any).
- The signature must be taken in ink or indelible pencil.

Rule 12. Delivery to Illiterate Addressees

- When an accountable article is delivered to an illiterate addressee, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- The mark or impression must be attested by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
- The postman himself cannot attest the mark / impression.

- Before proceeding on his beat, a postman should be careful to see that there is sufficient printer ink in the special ink pad supplied to him for taking thumb impression.

Rule 13. Delivery of Insured Articles

- Insured articles must be delivered only to the addressee or his authorised agent.
- Insured articles exceeding the value of Rs. 500 (Manual limit) must not be delivered by the postman: an intimation is delivered instead.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Operational note

Operational SB Orders have enhanced cash-handling limits for postmen / GDS in many circumstances (e.g. AePS / cash withdrawal at the doorstep up to Rs. 40,000 in some Circles). For Vol. VI Part III examination, however, retain the Rs. 500 limit for insured articles unless the question specifies "current ruling".

Rule 14. Payment of Money Orders

- Money Orders (now primarily MO under the new framework) must be paid to the payee named in the order at the address given.
- The postman must satisfy himself as to the identity of the payee.
- The signature of the payee must be obtained on the Money Order and the acknowledgement.

Summary of Important Forms (Vol. VI, Part III)

Form No.	Description
MS-27	Postman's Book
RP-53	Book of Receipts for Intimations / Notices (also used for parcels >10 kg)
RP-54	COD Intimation (legacy V.P. intimation form)
M-1	Cash Bag (general)
M-2	Transit Bag
PA-11	Sub-Account (Village Postman)
M-52	Village Sorting List
M-53	Route List (Village Postman)
MS-86	Visit Book — Sub-Account PA

Rule 15. Articles Addressed to Minors

- Articles addressed to minors should always be delivered to them in the presence of their parents or guardians, or to the parents or guardians themselves.
- If the minor is not living with his parent or guardian, the article may be delivered to the minor himself, provided the postman is satisfied that the minor is able to understand the nature of the transaction.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Liability and good-faith delivery

Section 10, Post Office Act, 2023: the Central Government incurs no liability for mis-delivery executed in good faith according to the prescribed rules. Operational instructions now favour verified delivery (e.g. OTP-based or digital signature) where the addressee is a minor, to avoid disputes.

Rule 16. Articles Addressed to Lunatics

- Articles addressed to lunatics should be delivered to their managers or legal guardians, if any.
- If there is no manager or legal guardian, the articles must be taken back to the post office and the Postmaster's orders obtained.

Rule 17. Delivery of Articles on which Customs Duty is Due

- When an article on which customs duty is due is made over to a postman for delivery, he must recover the amount of the duty from the addressee before delivering the article.
- The postman is not authorised to open the article to allow the addressee to examine the contents before payment of the duty.
- The receipt for the customs duty (usually pasted on the article) must be signed by the postman and given to the addressee.

Rule 18. Delivery of Articles on which Demurrage Fee is Due

- If a demurrage fee (warehousing charge) is due on a parcel or other article, the postman must recover the fee in addition to any other charges due before delivery.
- The amount of demurrage due is noted on the article or the accompanying receipt.

Rule 19. Doubtful Cases

- In any case of doubt as to the identity of the addressee or the person claiming delivery, or if the addressee refuses to sign the receipt or acknowledgement, the postman must bring the article back to the post office.

Rule 20. Delivery of COD Articles (formerly V.P.)

- A COD article can be delivered only on payment of the amount specified for remittance to the sender, together with the commission (if any).
- The postman must obtain the signature of the addressee on the receipt and the COD voucher / MO form.
- If the addressee complains of the condition of the article or suspects that it has been tampered with, the postman must not deliver it but must bring it back to the post office.

STATUTORY UPDATE — VPP merged with COD under PO Regulations, 2024

Per the DO Letter dated 20.12.2024 (Annexure), VPP is merged with COD; COD has been extended to retail customers also. Manual references to "V.P." should be read as "COD".

Rule 21. Intimation of COD Articles

- When a COD article exceeds Rs. 500 in value, or exceeds the limit prescribed for delivery by a single postman, the article is not sent out for delivery; instead, an intimation (**Form RP-54**) is prepared and made over to the postman for delivery to the addressee.
- The postman delivers the intimation and obtains the addressee's signature in his Book of Receipts for Intimations (**Form RP-53**).

EXAM TIP — COD doorstep limits in practice

Operational circulars have enhanced the door-delivery threshold for COD articles (often Rs. 5,000 or higher depending on Circle / city classification). The Manual figure of Rs. 500 remains the examination-default unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Chapter 3 — Payment of Money Orders by Postmen

Rule 23. Payment of Money Orders (General)

- Money Orders made over to a postman for payment must be paid to the payee named in the order.
- The postman takes the payee's signature on the Money Order and on the Acknowledgement.
- He also signs the Money Order himself in the space provided for the "Postman's Signature".

STATUTORY UPDATE — Smart Postman / digital acknowledgement

With the rollout of DARPAN 2.0 and Smart Postman devices, the physical signature is often replaced or supplemented by biometric authentication or digital signature on the mobile device. The acknowledgement is then often digital (SMS confirmation to the sender).

Rule 24. Payment to Illiterate Payees

- If the payee is illiterate, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the Money Order and Acknowledgement.
- The mark is attested by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
- The postman enters the name and address of the witness on the Money Order.

Rule 25. Payment to Purdah-Nashin Women

- If the payee is a purdah-nashin woman (a woman who does not appear in public), the Money Order is paid to her in the presence of a witness who can identify her.
- If she is illiterate, her mark is obtained and attested by a witness.
- The postman must satisfy himself that payment actually reaches the proper person.

Rule 26. Payment of Money Orders to Minors

- A Money Order payable to a minor must be paid to the parent or legal guardian with whom the minor is living.
- The parent or guardian signs the Money Order on behalf of the minor (e.g. "X, father and guardian of Y").
- If the minor is of sufficient age and discretion and is living apart from his parents / guardians, payment may be made to the minor himself.

Rule 27. Payment of Money Orders to Lunatics

- Money Orders payable to persons of unsound mind are paid only to the Manager of the estate or the legally appointed guardian.
- Under no circumstances is payment made to the lunatic himself.

Rule 28. Identification of Payee

- The postman is responsible for the correct payment of the Money Order.
- If the payee is not permanently resident in the postman's beat, or is not personally known to him, the postman must require the payee to be identified by some respectable person known to the postman.
- The identifier signs the Money Order in the space provided.

Rule 29. Payment by Village Postman

- A Village Postman is authorised to pay Money Orders up to the limit of cash entrusted to him (see Rule 26 Part II for the tiered table).
- He proceeds under the same rules as a regular postman regarding identification and receipts.

Rule 30. Money Orders Not Paid (Void / Refused)

- If the payee refuses to take payment, or cannot be found, or if the payee is deceased, the Money Order is brought back to the post office.
- The postman notes the reason for non-payment (e.g. "Refused", "Left", "Deceased") on the Money Order.
- In case of "Refused", the refusal is attested by the postman.
- **A postman may in no circumstances keep an article in his possession for more than 24 hours.**

Chapter 4 — Cash Conveyance & Sub-Accounts**Rule 9. Limits for Remittance by Various Modes of Conveyance**

Per Security-Branch instructions (Postal Manual Vol VI Part III §9), the per-mode cash-conveyance ceilings are:

Mode of conveyance	Maximum amount
(a) Loose cash through Departmental Employee	Rs. 5,00,000
(b) Departmental MMS with MTS in addition to driver — cash in cash bags enclosed in account bag	Rs. 20,00,000
(c)(i) Hired MMS with MTS in addition to driver — cash in cash bags in account bag, within city limit	Rs. 5,00,000
(c)(ii) Hired MMS with MTS in addition to driver — outside city limit	Rs. 2,00,000
(d) Cash bag enclosed in Account bag through RMS Section / Railway	Rs. 2,00,000
(e) Account bag handed over to courier (weightment system / road transport)	Rs. 40,000
(f) Under Armed Escort	No limit
(g) Cash through Departmental Employee accompanied by another departmental employee	Rs. 10,00,000
(h) Cash through BPM / ABPM / GDS	Rs. 1,00,000
(i) Cash through BPM / ABPM / GDS accompanied by another BPM or GDS	Rs. 2,00,000

- **Remittance at night on foot lines** should be authorized by the Head of Circle.
- **Night, for this purpose**, ordinarily means **07:00 PM to 05:30 AM in summer**.
- **In winter**, this time will be **06:30 PM to 06:00 AM**.

Rule 23. Remittances through Special Carriers

- If the remittance is made over loose to the carrier, he should be required to grant a receipt for the sum in the treasurer's cash book.
- If the remittance is to be closed in a cash bag, the money together with a memo giving full particulars of the remittance should be placed inside the bag; the bag should be closed and weighed in the presence of the carrier, who should be required to grant a receipt for it in treasurer's cash book.
- The treasurer must see on the return of the carrier to the office that a receipt for the remittance has been obtained in his book or diary.

Rule 24-A. Lists of Registered Insured articles

- Where the number of accountable / insured articles is **3 or more than 3**, a list of accountable insured articles should be prepared on plain paper in **duplicate** by the Registered PA and made over to the Sub-Account PA.

Rule 27. Closing of Account Bags in the Head Office

- If any remittance of cash or stamps or reply-coupons is to be made, the account bag, when ready to be closed, will be taken by the Sub-Account assistant to the treasurer together with all the articles and documents for despatch.
- The cash, stamps or reply coupons to be sent to the Sub-Office should then be enclosed in a cash bag by the treasurer in the presence of the Sub-Account PA, who is not required to count the cash or stamps.
- **Black sealing wax** should be used for the purpose of sealing the cash bag.
- After the cash bag is closed and sealed, the Sub-Account assistant should himself weigh the bag and enter its weight both in word and figures on the label of the bag and also on both copies of the SO daily slip, and have entries of weight attested and initialled by the treasurer.
- As far as practicable, the Sub-Account PA should not be either the mail or sorting assistant.
- But when the combination of these duties cannot be avoided, all the account bags — whether they contain cash bag or not — should be sealed with the cash seal by the treasurer and with the sub-account seal by the Sub-Account PA.
- The cord for the cash seal should be tied tightly round the neck of the account bag just above the sub-account seal.
- The cash seal should be impressed on good red sealing wax.

Rule 28. Opening of account and cash bag in Sub Office

- The account bag received from the HO should be carefully examined by the SPM before it is opened.

Rule 43. Opening of account bags in the Head Office

- The account bags received by a HO from its SO will be made over by the mail or delivery department under receipt to the treasurer, who will open the bag in the presence of the Sub-Account PA.
- The account bags or sealed bags sent loose received by a HO from its SO after the close of day's transaction should be made over to the treasurer by the mail or delivery department under receipt.
- The treasurer should enter the total number of such bags in **Column C of the HO Summary (ACG-1)**.

Rule 51. SO certificate list and documents

- The receipts so obtained should invariably be preserved along with the SO daily accounts for the same period as prescribed for SO daily account, i.e., **18 months**.

Rule 54. Adjustment of incorrect account items

- If the daily account of SO has been checked, and any account item is found to be wrong, the correct amount should be entered in the account of the HO, but the SPM's figures in the daily accounts should not be corrected or altered in any way.
- The daily account received from an SO should never be returned for correction of errors.

Rule 55. Entries in the accounts of the head office of remittances received

- The remittance received from SOs in account with the HO should be credited in the HO Summary and treasurer's cash book on the actual dates of receipt, whether the SO daily accounts in which they are advised have or have not been received.

Rule 56. Postage in transit between HO and SO

- A remittance to a HO from one of its SOs, if received before the daily account in which it is advised, will be credited in the HO Summary and in the treasurer's cash book and will also be shown in the SO Summary as a minus entry until the daily account in which the remittance is advised is received and copied into the SO Summary.
- The total of the SO balances after deduction of minus entries should be transferred to the Postmaster's Balance Sheet.

Rule 57. SO Daily Account to be copied into SO Summary (March Closing)

- The transactions of SO during the closing day of March which are not included in the SO summary for March should be entered in a **Supplementary SO Summary for March** and not in the ordinary SO Summary of April.
- As soon as the SO daily accounts of all SOs of 31st March have been received in head office, the supplementary SO Summary should be closed.

Rule 32. Sub-Account System (Village Postmen)

- Village Postmen entrusted with cash and stamps for Sub-Offices or Branch Offices on their beat must carry a **Sub-Account Portfolio**.
- The portfolio contains the Sub-Account (**Form PA-11**), the cash bag and the accountable / insured articles.
- The Village Postman is responsible for the safe custody of the portfolio and its contents while on his beat.

Rule 33. Exchange of Sub-Accounts

- On reaching a Sub-Office or Branch Office, the Village Postman makes over the Sub-Account Portfolio to the Sub-Postmaster or Branch Postmaster.
- He waits until the portfolio is returned to him with the return Sub-Account and the articles / cash for the Head Office or Account Office.
- He checks the contents of the portfolio in the presence of the Sub / Branch Postmaster before leaving the office.

Rule 62. Mode of Sending Remittance to Branch office

- Bag containing Cash, Stamps or reply coupons to be sent to BO should be closed by treasurer in the presence of Sub Account PA.
- After the cash bag has been closed and sealed, the Sub-Account PA should himself weigh the bag and enter its weight both in word and figure on the label of the bag and also on both copies of the BO Slip.
- In sub offices where there are no treasurers, the carrier's receipt should be taken in the BO Summary.

Rule 63. BO Slip (PA-4)

- The BO Slips are to be prepared in **duplicate** by means of double-side carbonic paper.
- The pencil copy should be kept on record in the account office.
- The carbonic copy should be detached and sent to the branch office.
- Both copies should be signed by the Sub-Account PA.

Rule 70. Disposal of COD Articles receipts

- The amount realised from addressees of COD articles delivered by BOs will be shown in the BO daily accounts under the head "**Money Order issued**".

Rule 74. Entries in BO Summary

- In SOs, the total amount of Postage, Cash and Stamps in transit should be added to the net balance and the total should be transferred to the SO account.

Rule 77. Entries in Visit Book (MS-86)

- The Sub-Account assistant should himself enter in the visit book.
- **Red ink** used by Sub-Account PA in MS-86 — the ABPM is not obliged to be visited on every trip but has to be visited in the village marked in red entries.
- **Black ink** used by Sub-Account PA in MS-86 — the villages have to be visited regularly.

Rule 81. Paid and Unpaid Money Order

- The amount of Money Order paid should be entered in the BO Summary under the head "**Money Order Paid**".
- The amount returned as unpaid should be shown under the head "**Cash remitted to the account office**" or paid back by village postman.

Rule 83. Realisation of letter Postage

- In sub office, amount collected on account of letter postage should be paid by the village postman to the Sub-Postmaster. If there is no treasurer, who should sign the entries in the village postman's registers in acknowledgement of receipt.

Rule 98. Preparation of SO Account

- **S.O. Account** — Form PA-17.
- The SO account for each month should comprise the dates of the daily accounts which are accounted for in HO from the first to the end of the month.
- For instance, if the daily account dated 30th May is accounted for in the month at head office on 1st June, and that dated 28th June is accounted for on 30th June — the SO account for the month of June should embrace the dates from 30th May to 28th June, both days inclusive.
- **Exception:** The transactions of the SO for the concluding days of March should be shown in the SO account for March. The entries however in the daily account of BOs for the concluding day of March which do not reach the SO before 1st April should be incorporated in SO account and BO Summary for April.

Rule 99. Checking Balance of SO Account

- The night post office will prepare the daily account on Sunday also.
- In the case of HOs, the HO Summary will be prepared on Sunday also, if they are kept open on Sunday — but the HO cash book need not be written up on Sundays.

Rule 102. Authorized Balance [PA-14(s)]

- The minimum and maximum cash balances will be fixed for each SO by the Superintendent.
- The memo of authorized balances received from the Superintendent should be pasted to a board or car board and hung up inside the SO.
- The maximum cash balance of a sub office will include the amounts with its village postmen.

Rule 121. Payments of Money Orders

- Before proceeding on his beat, a postman should be careful to see that there is sufficient printer ink in the special ink pad supplied to him for taking thumb impression.

Rule 129. Return of Undelivered Articles

- A postman may in no circumstances keep an article in his possession for more than 24 hours.

Rule 142. Undelivered articles and Unpaid Money Order

- In SOs, the cash for unpaid money orders should be made over by village postmen to the money order assistant under receipt, to be taken in their register.

Rule 144. Duties of Mail Attendants

- Mail Attendants are employed in post offices situated at or near Railway Stations.

Chapter 5 — Duties of Head Postmen

Rule 36. General Duties

- The Head Postman is responsible for the general supervision of the delivery work.
- He must see that postmen attend office punctually and are neat and clean in appearance.
- He must ensure that postmen leave the office for their beats at the prescribed time.

Rule 37. Testing of Letter Boxes

- The Head Postman is required to test the letter boxes on the postmen's beats to ensure that they are cleared punctually.

- He drops test letters into the letter boxes at different times and watches for their arrival at the post office. Any irregularity or delay in clearance is reported to the Postmaster.

Rule 38. Verification of Payment of Money Orders

- The Head Postman is employed to verify the payment of Money Orders.
- He visits the payees of a percentage of Money Orders paid by each postman to ascertain whether the amounts were paid in full and without demand for illegal gratification.
- The result of his enquiries is noted in a Visit Book or Diary.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital monitoring

Verification targets are now monitored digitally. The Head Postman (or PRI / Overseer) must verify 100% of MOs exceeding a certain value (e.g. Rs. 5,000) and a percentage of lower-value MOs, entering findings in the Postman Mobile App where available.

Rule 39. Enquiry into Complaints

- Minor complaints from the public regarding delivery of letters or the conduct of postmen may be made over to the Head Postman for enquiry.
- He submits a written report of the result of his enquiry to the Postmaster.

Rule 40. Taking out Letter-Box Keys

- The Head Postman may be entrusted with the master key of the letter boxes to inspect the interior of the boxes.
- He must account for the key whenever it is taken out and returned.

Chapter 6 — Duties of Letter-Box Attendants

Rule 41. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- Letter-Box Peons (or Attendants) are employed to clear street letter boxes.
- They must clear the boxes strictly in accordance with the hours of clearance shown on the hour-plates. They bring the contents of the boxes to the post office immediately after clearance.

Rule 42. Changing of Hour-Plates

- At each clearance, the Letter-Box Peon must change the hour-plate to show the time of the next clearance.
- If the box is provided with a movable indicator, he adjusts it to the proper time.
- Failure to change the hour-plate is a serious irregularity.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Smart Letter Boxes (Nanyatha)

Many modern "Smart Letter Boxes" (Nanyatha) carry a barcoded sticker inside. The attendant must scan the barcode using the Nanyatha App on his mobile device to log the clearance time and location (GPS-tagged) electronically. The physical hour-plate rules continue to apply unless the box is fully digital.

Rule 43. Security of Letter-Box Keys

- The key of the letter box must be kept attached to the peon's person by a chain or strap. He must not allow the key to pass out of his custody or lend it to anyone.

Rule 44. Damaged Letter Boxes

- If a Letter-Box Peon finds a letter box damaged, insecure or tampered with, he must not clear it but must guard it and send word to the post office for assistance. He must report the matter to the Postmaster immediately.

Rule 45. Examination of Locks

- The Letter-Box Peon examines the lock of every letter box he clears to see that it is in good order. If the lock is stiff or difficult to open, he reports the fact to the Postmaster so that it may be oiled or repaired.

Chapter 7 — Uniforms and Badges**Rule 46. Supply of Uniforms**

- Postmen and Letter-Box Peons are supplied with uniforms and warm clothing (liveries) at Government expense.
- They are required to wear their uniforms while on duty.
- Officials not wearing the prescribed uniform are liable to be treated as absent from duty.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — 7th CPC Dress Allowance

The 7th CPC Dress Allowance has replaced the physical supply of uniforms for most cadres. Eligible employees receive a Dress Allowance (currently Rs. 5,000 per annum) credited directly to salary in July, and are expected to procure and maintain the prescribed khaki / blue uniforms themselves.

Rule 47. Maintenance of Uniforms

- Postmen must keep their uniforms clean and in good repair.
- They must not modify the pattern of the uniform supplied to them.
- A postman appearing for duty in a dirty or untidy uniform is liable to punishment.

Rule 48. Badges

- Every postman and Letter-Box Peon is supplied with a badge (usually brass or metal) bearing the word "Postman" or "Letter Box Peon" and a number.
- The badge is worn in a conspicuous place on the left breast of the coat or tunic.
- A postman must not go on his beat without his badge.

Rule 49. Umbrellas and Raincoats

- Umbrellas or waterproof capes / raincoats are supplied to postmen and Letter-Box Peons in localities where the rainfall is heavy.
- These articles remain the property of Government and must be returned to the office when the official leaves the service or proceeds on long leave.

Rule 50. Renewal of Liveries

- Periods of wear for various articles of livery (coats, turbans, boots, etc.) are prescribed by the Head of the Circle.
- An article cannot be renewed before the expiry of the prescribed period unless it has been lost or damaged through no fault of the official.

Chapter 8 — Prohibitions, Offences & Village Postmen / GDS

Rule 55. Prohibition against engaging in Trade or Business

- A postman is prohibited from engaging in any trade or business on his own account.
- He must not act as an agent for any firm or dealer.
- He is forbidden to distribute advertisements, handbills or trade circulars for the public while on duty.

Rule 56. Prohibition against acting as Professional Letter-Writer

- A postman is forbidden to act as a professional letter-writer.
- He may assist illiterate persons in reading or writing letters gratuitously (without payment), provided it does not interfere with his regular duties.

Rule 57. Prohibition against Money Lending

- Postmen are strictly prohibited from lending money on interest to the public or to other postal officials.
- They must not borrow money from persons residing on their beats.

Rule 58. Offences punishable under the Post Office Act

Postmen should be aware that the following acts are offences:

- wilful detention or delay of any postal article;
- opening or tampering with any postal article;
- making away with (theft / destruction of) any postal article;
- falsely noting "Refused", "Addressee not found" or "Left" on an article;
- demanding more postage than is due.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Penal framework under the Post Office Act, 2023

The Post Office Act, 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024) replaced the Indian Post Office Act, 1898. The principal penal / regulatory provisions are:

Section 7: the Central Government may make rules — and the Director-General may make regulations (Section 13) — prescribing the conditions and standards for postal services, including the consequences of breach.

Section 9: powers of interception of postal articles by officers empowered by the Central Government, on the grounds of public emergency, public safety, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, or prevention of incitement to the commission of any offence.

Section 10: limitation of Government liability — no liability for loss, mis-delivery, delay or damage to any item, except as may be prescribed.

Rule 59. Prohibition against giving Information

- A postman must not give any information to the public regarding the receipt or despatch of mails or the addresses of persons served by the post office.
- He must not give information regarding the value of articles delivered to any person.

Rule 60. Loitering and Deviation from Beat

- A postman must not loiter on his beat or waste time in conversation.
- He must not deviate from the prescribed route of his beat without valid reason.
- If he is found to be habitually irregular in his beat, he is liable to severe punishment.

Duties of Village Postmen / GDS

STATUTORY UPDATE — GDS in current context

In the modern context, the duties described in this section are primarily performed by Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS) — specifically the Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) for delivery and conveyance and the Branch Postmaster (BPM) for office management. Although the Manual uses the term "Village Postman", examinations test the GDS rules alongside.

Rule 61. Definition and Beat

- Village Postmen are attached to Head or Sub-Offices for the delivery of correspondence in rural tracts.
- A Village Postman's beat includes a number of villages which he visits at fixed intervals.

Rule 62. Route List and Beat Map

- Every Village Postman is supplied with a Route List (**Form M-53**) showing the names of the villages on his beat, the days on which they are to be visited and the hours of arrival and departure.
- He is also supplied with a Beat Map showing the villages and the route to be followed.
- He must strictly adhere to the route and timings prescribed.

Rule 63. Attendance and Examination of Contents

- The Village Postman attends the post office at the prescribed hour to receive the articles for delivery.
- He examines the articles made over to him to see that they are in good condition and that the acknowledgements for accountable / insured articles are attached.
- He checks the entries in the Sub-Account or Register against the articles received.

Rule 64. Forms and Stock

A Village Postman must carry a stock of:

- Postage Stamps and Stationery for sale;
- Money-Order forms;
- Acknowledgement forms;
- Common Proof of Delivery (CPD) cards, if applicable.
- He must also carry a pencil and a stamp pad (ink pad) for taking thumb-impressions.

Rule 65. Delivery of Articles in Villages

- On arriving at a village, the Village Postman proceeds to the usual place of resort (e.g. the village chavadi or headman's house) or goes from house to house to deliver articles.
- He must not detain articles for a future visit if the addressee is present in the village.
- If the addressee is not found, the article may be delivered to a responsible member of his family (subject to rules for specific articles), or kept for the next visit if the addressee is expected to return shortly (within the limit of retention).

Rule 66. Articles for Persons who have Left

- If the addressee has left the village and his new address is known, the Village Postman notes the new address on the article and returns it to the post office for redirection.

- If the new address is not known, the article is noted "Left without instructions" and returned.

Rule 67. Collection of Articles for Despatch

- The Village Postman is authorised to receive unregistered letters and postcards from the public for despatch.
- He must see that such articles are fully prepaid with postage stamps.
- He cannot accept accountable articles or Money Orders for booking unless specifically authorised.



STATUTORY UPDATE — DARPAN 2.0 booking by GDS

Under current DARPAN 2.0 implementations, GDS (BPMs / ABPMs) provided with mobile devices can book Speed Post (Document and Parcel) — which now subsumes legacy Registered articles — and also accept Money Orders while on the beat, generating a digital receipt.

Rule 68. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- The Village Postman clears all letter boxes situated in the villages on his beat.
- He clears them at the hours specified in his Route List.
- He locks the boxes securely after clearance.

Rule 69. Sale of Stamps

- The Village Postman is required to sell postage stamps and stationery to the public for cash.
- He must not sell stamps on credit.
- The cash realised from sales is kept distinct from other cash (such as Money-Order cash).

Rule 70. Procedure for Accountable Articles

- Accountable articles are delivered only to the addressee or his agent.
- The signature is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- If the addressee is illiterate, the procedure for thumb-impression and witness-attestation (per Rule 12 / Rule 24) must be followed strictly.

Rule 71. Limit of Cash for Payment

- The aggregate value of Money Orders and Insured Articles entrusted to a Village Postman / GDS for payment at one time must not exceed the limits fixed under Rule 26 (Part II) — Rs. 15,000 normal / Rs. 25,000 under Division-Head power (rural & urban).

Rule 72. Overnight Halts

- If a Village Postman's beat is too large to be covered in one day, he may be required to halt overnight at a specified village.
- He must sleep at a secure place (e.g. school, panchayat office or headman's house) approved by the Postmaster.
- He is responsible for the safety of the cash and mails during the halt.

Rule 73. Return to Office

On his return to the post office, the Village Postman delivers:

- all undelivered articles;
- the signed receipts / acknowledgements for delivered articles;
- the cash realised from COD articles and Customs Duty;
- the cash from the sale of stamps (for replenishment of stock);
- the articles collected from letter boxes.

Rule 74. Infectious Diseases

- If a Village Postman knows that plague, smallpox or any other dangerous infectious disease constitutes a specific danger in any village on his beat, he must not enter that village.
- He reports the fact to the Postmaster immediately.
- Articles for such villages are detained at the post office until it is safe to deliver them.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Modern context

While "plague / smallpox" are historical terms in the Manual, the rule applies to modern outbreaks (e.g. containment zones in pandemic-management orders). Delivery is restricted to the boundary of the containment zone or suspended as per local Health-Authority guidelines.

Rule 75. Forbidden Practices

Village Postmen are forbidden to:

- carry private parcels or letters for the public outside the post;
- demand "bakshish" or tips for delivery;
- allow any unauthorised person to accompany them on their beat.

Quick-Revision Summary — Key Numerical & Statutory Anchors

The following table consolidates the most frequently tested figures, dates and citations across all three parts of Volume VI. Every entry in v2 has been verified against the underlying Gazette notification, the Department's DO Letter dated 20.12.2024, or the Postal Manual base text.

A. Statutory Framework

Topic	Current statutory position	Source / authority
Post Office Act, 2023 — commencement	18 June 2024	Ministry of Communications notification dated 17.06.2024
Post Office Rules, 2024	Effective 16.12.2024	G.S.R. 767(E) dt 16.12.2024
Post Office Regulations, 2024	Effective 16.12.2024	S.O. 5440(E) dt 16.12.2024
DO Letter — Major Changes Annexure	Issued 20.12.2024	DO No. 01-01/2024-PO, Member (Operations), Postal Services Board
Repeal of earlier Act	Indian Post Office Act, 1898 repealed	Section 1 of Post Office Act, 2023

B. Mail & Parcel Products (post DO Letter, 20.12.2024)

Product	Current position	Notes
Letter	Weight ceiling 500 grams	Annexure, Letter Post row
Letter Cards	No major change	Annexure
Post Cards	Printed-comm. / Competition / Meghdoot postcards subsumed	Registration VAS now available on postcards

Product	Current position	Notes
Book Post (new)	Subsumes Book Packets, BP-Printed Books, Pattern/Sample Packets	Annexure
Periodical Post	Renamed from Book Packets containing periodicals	Conditions retained
Registered Newspaper	Periodicity: at least once in a week	Per Press & Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023
Business Reply Envelopes & Cards	Omitted	Annexure
India Post Parcel (new)	Subsumes Parcel (Ordinary) + Business Parcel; accountable	Retail and contractual rates differ
Speed Post — split	Speed Post Document + Speed Post Parcel	Annexure
Gyan Post	300 g – 5 kg; Rs. 20 – Rs. 100 + GST	PO 2nd Amendment Regulations 2025, effective 01.05.2025
24 Speed Post Parcel	6 metro cities; OTP bundled free	PO 2nd Amendment Regulations 2026, effective 17.03.2026

C. Value-Added Services

Service	Current position	Source
Registration	No major change; available on Postcards too	Annexure
Insurance — Speed Post (HO)	Up to Rs. 10,00,000	Financial Services Division
Insurance — Branch Post Office	Rs. 600	Manual Vol VI Pt I
Currency notes by Insured Post	Rs. 20,000	Financial Services Division

Service	Current position	Source
OTP delivery — Speed Post	Rs. 5 + GST per item	PO 4th Amendment Regulations 2025, S.O. 4375(E) dt 25.09.2025
Value Payable Post (VPP)	Merged with COD	Annexure
Cash on Delivery (COD)	Up to Rs. 50,000 per article; now available to retail customers also	Annexure
Speed Post compensation	Double the charges or Rs. 1,000, whichever is less	DoP compensation schedule
International accountable compensation	30 SDR	UPU Convention

D. Money Order & Postal Order

Topic	Current statutory position	Source
MO — product renaming	eMO renamed simply "Money Order"	Annexure
MO — Family Allotment Money Order	Omitted	Annexure
Single MO maximum	Rs. 10,000 (raised from Rs. 5,000)	Annexure; Regulation 147
Retail MO per person per month	Rs. 25,000	Proviso to Regulation 147
Three types of MO	Retail / Bulk / Service	Regulation 147
Free MO	PM Relief Fund, PM CARES, CM Relief Fund, other notified funds	Regulation 147(3)
MO currency period	End of last day of second month following month of issue	Regulation 154; Manual Vol VI Pt II §65
MO complaint window	12 months from date of issue	Manual Vol VI Pt II §67

Topic	Current statutory position	Source
MO — PAO consultation rule	1 year from date of issue (for re-payment / adjustments)	Manual Vol VI Pt II §67
MO — Forfeiture	3 years from date of booking	Regulation 155; Manual Vol VI Pt II §67
Postal Order — denominations	Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50, Rs. 100	Annexure; Regulation 157
e-IPO denomination	Rs. 10	Regulation 157
IPO validity — 1st period (no fee)	24 months from last day of month of issue	Regulation 158
IPO validity — 2nd period (with fee)	24 to 36 months	Regulation 158
IPO — broken amount stamps	Max 4 stamps; on face or reverse	Regulation 157
MO paid voucher preservation	18 months	Manual Vol VIII
Bulk MO list preservation	6 months	Manual Vol VIII
Foreign MO record preservation	3 years	Manual Vol VIII

E. Cash Conveyance Limits (Manual Vol VI Pt III §9)

Mode of conveyance	Maximum amount
(a) Loose cash through Departmental Employee	Rs. 5,00,000
(b) Departmental MMS + MTS + driver (cash bag in account bag)	Rs. 20,00,000
(c)(i) Hired MMS + MTS + driver — within city	Rs. 5,00,000
(c)(ii) Hired MMS + MTS + driver — outside city	Rs. 2,00,000
(d) Cash bag in account bag — RMS Section / Railway	Rs. 2,00,000
(e) Account bag to courier (weighment / road transport)	Rs. 40,000
(f) Under Armed Escort	No limit

Mode of conveyance	Maximum amount
(g) Departmental Employee + another departmental employee	Rs. 10,00,000
(h) BPM / ABPM / GDS alone	Rs. 1,00,000
(i) BPM / ABPM / GDS + another BPM/GDS	Rs. 2,00,000

F. Postman Single MO Payment Limit (Manual Vol VI Pt II §26)

Category of Staff	Normal Rural	Normal Urban	Div Head Rural	Div Head Urban
Postman / MTS (delivery)	Rs. 30,000	Rs. 40,000	Rs. 40,000*	Rs. 80,000*
Village Postman	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000
BPM / ABPM / GDS	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 15,000	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 25,000

*Division-Head enhanced powers exercisable only with prior consultation with Police. Head-of-Circle power: Unlimited with prior consultation with Police.

G. Parcel — Dimensions & Volumetric

Parameter	Limit
Maximum weight (India Post Parcel)	20 kg
Maximum length	1.5 metres
Maximum length + girth	3 metres
Volumetric weight divisor (kg)	$L \times W \times H \div 5000$ (cm)
Compulsory accountable-item booking (parcel)	> 4 kg

H. POSB — Current Position

Topic	Current position	Source
Minimum balance — with cheque facility	Rs. 500	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018

Topic	Current position	Source
Minimum balance — without cheque facility	Rs. 50	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018
Account maintenance fee (if below minimum)	Rs. 50 per financial year	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018
Interest rate (Q4 FY 2025-26)	4.0% per annum	Ministry of Finance interest-rate notification
Inoperative threshold	3 financial years (interest still credited)	POSB Rules 2019
ATM daily withdrawal	Rs. 25,000	SB Order
Counter withdrawal (without supervisor)	Rs. 20,000	SB Order
GDS withdrawal at BO — per customer	Rs. 20,000	SB Order
Deceased claim — Sub-Postmaster (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 50,000	SB Order
Deceased claim — Head Postmaster (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 5,00,000	SB Order
Deceased claim — Superintendent (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 10,00,000	SB Order

I. Custody, Records & Operational Timelines

Topic	Current position
Cash bag threshold (Pt I §27)	Rs. 250 (not Rs. 500)
Iron safe — locks	Double lock; one key with Postmaster, other with Treasurer
Iron chest — 2 hasps	One padlock + one sparling lock
Iron chest — 1 hasp	Sparling lock

Topic	Current position
Head of Circle circular periodicity	Once a month
Head of Circle circulars — destruction	3 years (from April following close of official year)
Postmaster's Order Book preservation	3 years (NOT Permanent)
Nominal Roll preservation	Permanent
Stock Book preservation	10 years (after replacement year)
Guard book of duplicate passbook applications	10 years
Confidential records / Character Sheet — death	2 years from death
Confidential records — retirement	5 years from retirement
Confidential records — invalid pension	25 years, or 3 years after death (whichever earlier)
Confidential records — disciplinary dismissal	6 years
Form MS-14	Statistical Abstract (NOT Error Book)
Form MS-14(a)	Monthly Statistical Memorandum (1st of each month)
Yearly Village Return — period	1st to 14th of March (both inclusive)
Yearly Village Return — sent to	Sub-Divisional Head
Big city — postage cash prepayment threshold	Min 500 packets
Small town — postage cash prepayment threshold	Min 250 packets
Night conveyance — summer window	07:00 PM – 05:30 AM
Night conveyance — winter window	06:30 PM – 06:00 AM
Postman article retention limit	24 hours
Mail Attendants — deployment	At or near Railway Stations
SO daily account — preservation	18 months

Topic	Current position
Treasury Remittance Book (ACG-8)	10 years

J. Schedule of Submissions

Submission	Due date
Schedule of UCR	1st and 11th of the month
MO returned	2nd and 16th of the month
MO issued and paid	2nd of the month
Void Money Order list (MO-19)	16th of the next month
MO list in HO — First Period	20th of the month
MO list in HO — Second Period	6th of the next month
Memorandum of distribution of Pay & Allowances (HO to Supdt.)	5th of the month following

K. Fees & Misc.

Topic	Current position
Identification Card fee	Rs. 100
Identification Card validity	3 years
Post Box rent (full FY) — Manual rate	Rs. 150
Post Box rent (3 calendar months) — Manual rate	Rs. 50
Post Box facility withdrawal — non-clearance	7 days despite notice (Regulation 47)
Dress Allowance (7th CPC)	Rs. 5,000 per annum
Franking machine rebate — threshold	Monthly consumption > Rs. 5,000
Franking machine rebate — rate	3% on entire amount
Mail / parcel retention — first attempt	7 days

Topic	Current position
Mail / parcel retention — extension on request	Additional 7 days (max 14 days total)
Warehousing charge — COD Letters / Packets	Rs. 3 per day
Warehousing charge — COD Parcels	Rs. 5 per day

EXAM TIP — Final consolidation note

This v2 edition reflects every material change required by (a) the audit of the previous Dak Guru consolidated text against the Postal Manual Vol VI base, (b) the DO No. 01-01/2024-PO of Member (Operations), Postal Services Board dated 20.12.2024 with its Annexure on Major Changes, and (c) the PO Regulations, 2024 itself.

For any operational decision in field offices, always cross-check the latest SB Order / RBO / DoP circular before reliance.

— END OF DOCUMENT —

Dak Guru | www.dakguru.com | India's First Smart Self-Preparation Portal

SELF LEARNING
PORTAL